Briefing Session on 2024 HKDSE Geography Examination

7 and 8 November 2024

香港考試及評核局
Hong Kong Examinations and Assessment Authority

HKDSE Geography examination Assessment Frameworks

Year	Remarks	Major amendments
2024	Interim Resumption Arrangement	FBQ: Optional FBQ topic: Climate Change (assigned)
2025 onwards	Normal	FBQ: Compulsory

2025 HKDSE Assessment Framework

	Paper 1		Paper 2	
Weighting:	75%		25%	
Duration:	2¾ hours		1¼ hour	
Scope:	Compulsory Part		Elective Part	
Section/ Question type:	A. Multiple-choice	(20%)	E. Data/Skill-based/Structured	(15%)
	B. Fieldwork-based	(15%)	F. Short Essay	(10%)
	C. Data/Skill-based/Structured	(30%)		
	D. Short Essay	(10%)		

For the 2025 HKDSE, candidates are expected to have fieldwork experiences in the following modules:

- Disappearing Green Canopy
- Climate Change
- Changing Industrial Location

2024 HKDSE Geography
Report on Examination Statistics

	Year	2024	2023	2022	2021
No of candidates	SCH/ 1	**7 464**	7 098	7 460	7 782
	WG	**8 186**	7 603	7 942	8 268

2024 HKDSE Geography
Report on Examination Statistics

Level	2024	2023	2022	2021
5**	1.2	1.3	1.2	1.3
5*	5.0	5.1	4.9	5.1
5	12.0	12.5	12.5	12.9
4	37.1	37.7	37.3	39.1
3	65.4	63.2	62.8	65.8
2	89.9	88.4	88.0	88.6
1	97.2	97.9	97	97.5
U	2.8	2.1	3.0	2.5

Figures refers to Day Schools (SCH/1) %

2024 HKDSE Geography
Report on Examination Statistics

Year	Mean (% mark)	SD (% mark)
2021	45.61	14.10
2022	45.52	14.72
2023	48.3	14.04
2024	**45.76**	**14.60**
Diff (2024-23)	**-2.53**	**0.56**

Figures refers to Day Schools (SCH/1) %

2024 HKDSE Geography
Report on Examination Statistics

MCQ Statistics				
	2024	**2023**	**2022**	**2021**
Mean (% mark)	**11.6 (58.0)**	12.3 (61.7)	11.2 (56.1)	9.9 (49.3)
SD (% mark)	**3.1 (15.7)**	3.2 (15.8)	2.91 (14.55)	2.86 (14.30)
Lowest	**1**	1	0	1
Highest	**20**	20	19	19

Total no. of MCQ : 20

Figures refers to Day Schools (SCH/1) %

2024 HKDSE Geography
Report on Examination Statistics

	Paper 1							
	Q1 (18)	**Q2 (18)**	**Q3 (18)**	**Q4 (18)**	**Q5 (18)**	**Q6 (12)**	**Q7 (12)**	**Q8 (12)**
Mean Score *(% marks)*	4.10 *(22.8)*	9.70 *(53.9)*	10.41 *(57.8)*	7.87 *(43.7)*	8.68 *(48.2)*	2.74 *(22.8)*	2.72 *(22.7)*	3.60 *(30.0)*
S.D.	3.09	3.72	3.98	3.02	3.65	1.91	1.91	2.16
Highest Score	**14**	**18**	**18**	**17**	**17**	**9**	**10**	**9**
Popularity (%)	4	86	36	82	91	26	50	22

2024 HKDSE Geography
Report on Examination Statistics

	Paper 2							
	Q1 (18)	**Q2 (18)**	**Q3 (18)**	**Q4 (18)**	**Q5 (12)**	**Q6 (12)**	**Q7 (12)**	**Q8 (12)**
Mean Score *(% marks)*	7.85 *(43.6)*	8.36 *(46.4)*	6.11 *(33.9)*	7.46 *(41.4)*	2.95 *(24.6)*	3.81 *(31.8)*	1.17 *(9.75)*	2.66 *(22.2)*
S.D.	3.96	3.83	2.55	3.13	1.88	2.35	1.27	1.91
Highest Score	**18**	**18**	**14**	**18**	**10**	**11**	**6**	**10**
Popularity (%)	40	27	7	26	48	21	4	26

School Survey on the 2024 HKDSE Geography Examination Papers

*The 2024 assessment framework of Geography enables a **comprehensive assessment** of candidates' achievements.*

Strongly agree	Agree	Slightly agree	Slightly disagree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
5.2%	79.9%	11.9%	2.2%	0.0%	0.7%

*The examination paper **structure** is appropriate.*

Strongly agree	Agree	Slightly agree	Slightly disagree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
6.0%	68.4%	15.8%	6.8%	2.3%	0.8%

School Survey on the 2024 HKDSE Geography Examination Papers

*The **weighting** of each paper is appropriate.*

Strongly agree	Agree	Slightly agree	Slightly disagree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
5.2%	76.9%	11.9%	5.2%	0.7%	0.0%

*The level of **difficulty** of the examination is appropriate.*

Strongly agree	Agree	Slightly agree	Slightly disagree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
6.0%	63.2%	17.3%	9.8%	3.8%	0.0%

School Survey on the 2024 HKDSE Geography Examination Papers

*The examination reflects the assessment **aims & objectives** stated in the **C & A Guide**.*

Strongly agree	Agree	Slightly agree	Slightly disagree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
3.0%	76.7%	16.5%	3.0%	0.8%	0.0%

*The examination is well-balanced in terms of **curriculum coverage**.*

Strongly agree	Agree	Slightly agree	Slightly disagree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
3.8%	66.7%	21.2%	3.8%	3.0%	1.5%

School Survey on the 2024 HKDSE Geography Examination Papers

*An appropriate **balance** between questions testing **basic knowledge / skills & those testing higher-order skills.***

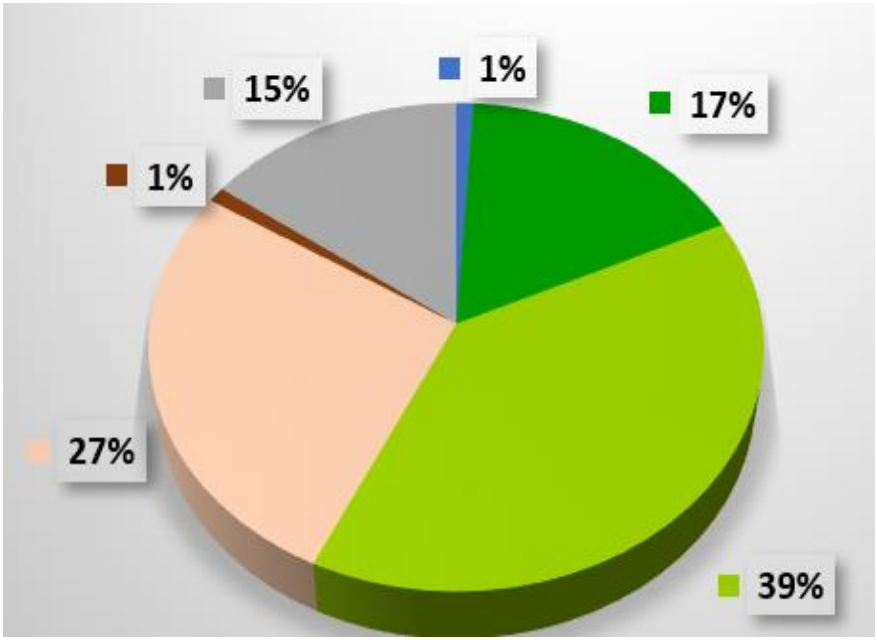
Strongly agree	Agree	Slightly agree	Slightly disagree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
6.1%	74.8%	13.7%	3.1%	2.3%	0.0%

*The **wording** of the questions is clear & easily understandable.*

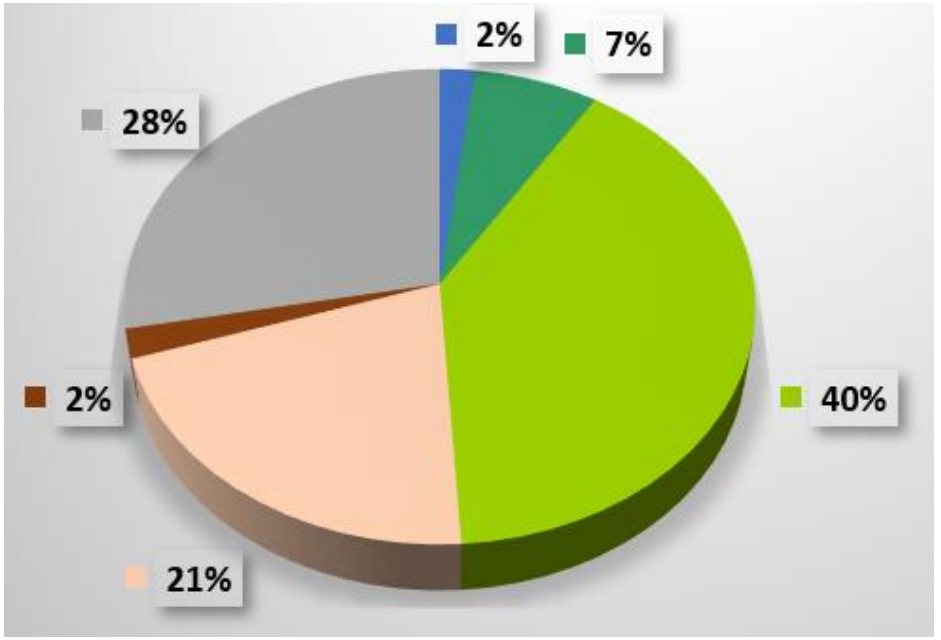
Strongly agree	Agree	Slightly agree	Slightly disagree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
3.8%	80.9%	12.2%	2.3%	0.0%	0.8%

Comments from Markers on Candidates' Standard Compared with 2023 Examination

Paper 1



Paper 2



Review of Candidates' Performance

2024 HKDSE Geography Paper 1

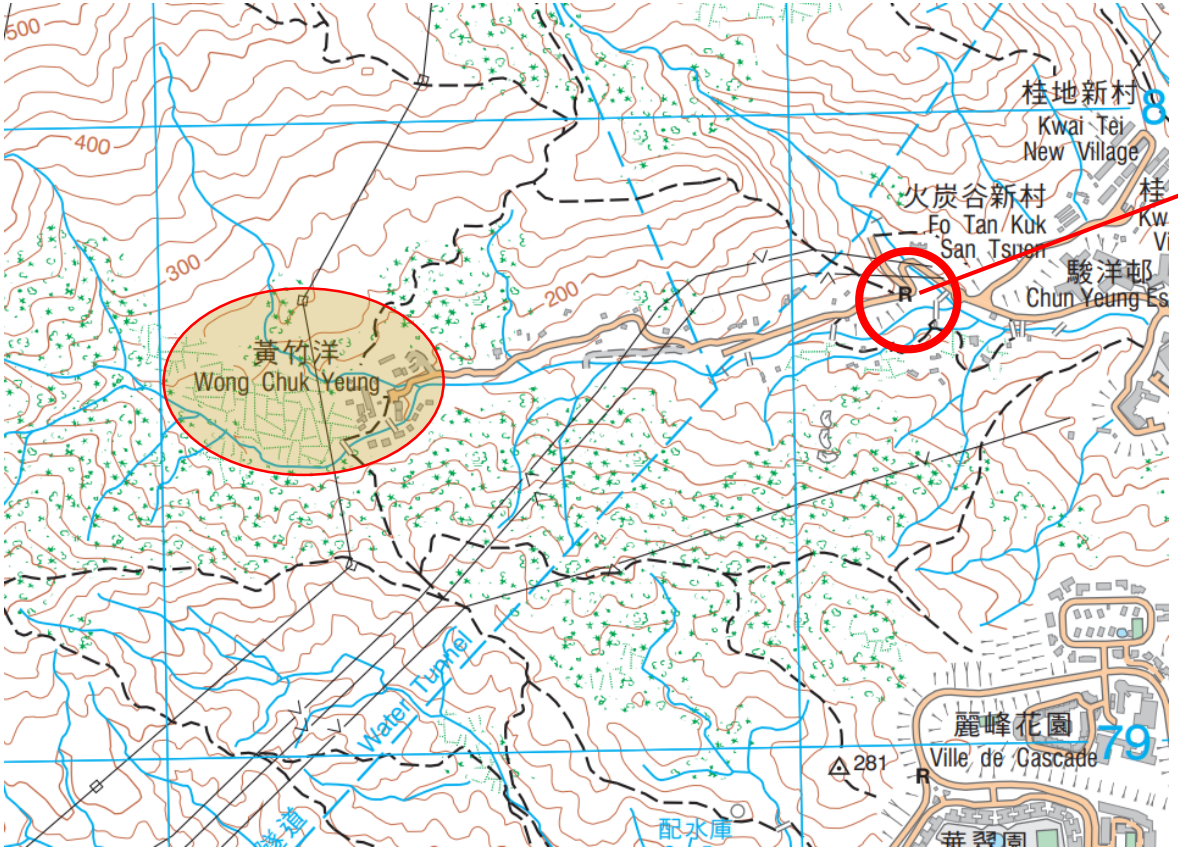
Section A

- The overall performance of candidates was about the same as last year.
- In Item 6, the most popular answer was Option D.
- Which of the following statements about grid square 0979 are correct?

  (1) There is cultivated land located below 280 m.
  (2) People can freely access Wong Chuk Yeung by cars.
  (3) There is electricity supply.

A.	(1) and (2) only	(8%)
B.*	(1) and (3) only	(33%)
C.	(2) and (3) only	(8%)
D.	(1), (2) and (3)	(51%)

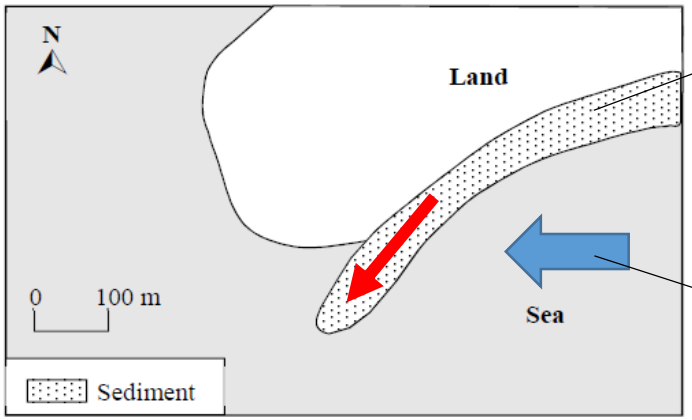
Section A



'R' at grid reference 101797 representing a restricted road

Section A

- In Item 9, the most popular answer was Option A.
- Refer to the figure below, which shows a section of coast.



misinterpreted the direction of the spit growth

Wind direction

The prevailing wind direction of this area is _____.

A.	south-west	(41%)
B.	west	(13%)
C.	north	(13%)
D.*	east	(33%)

Section A

- In Item 12, the most popular answer was Option C.
- Which of the following manufacturing activities is raw material-oriented?

A.	bread making	(9%)
B.*	cheese making	(40%)
C.	car manufacturing	(43%)
D.	newspaper printing	(8%)

Candidates might have thought that car manufacturing is a manufacturing procedure which involves many large and heavy raw materials

Section A

- In Item 13, the most popular answer was Option C.
- Refer to the photograph below, which shows land use X in Hong Kong.

Candidates might not be aware of the high traffic flow into/out of the container yard



Which of the following adverse social impacts is/are brought about by land use X?

(1) traffic congestion
(2) unpleasant view
(3) disruption of rural lifestyle

A.	(1) only	(2%)
B.	(1) and (2) only	(10%)
C.	(2) and (3) only	(47%)
D.*	(1), (2) and (3)	(41%)

Section A

- In Item 20, the most popular answer was Option D.
- Which of the following are possible consequences caused by the rise of the global mean sea level?

  (1) an increase in wave erosion
  (2) the resettlement of the people who live in coastal lowlands
  (3) higher frequency of tropical cyclones

Candidates might have thought that the formation of tropical cyclones results from the rise of the global mean sea level.

A.*	(1) and (2) only	(26%)
B.	(1) and (3) only	(8%)
C.	(2) and (3) only	(17%)
D.	(1), (2) and (3)	(49%)

Section B – Question 1 (FBQ – optional)

1. A class of students carried out a geography field study on the wind speed in an urban area. Figure 1a shows some guidelines for the field study. Table 1b shows the wind speed data collected at the sampling points. Figure 1c is the graphical representation of the collected data shown in Table 1b.

Figure 1a

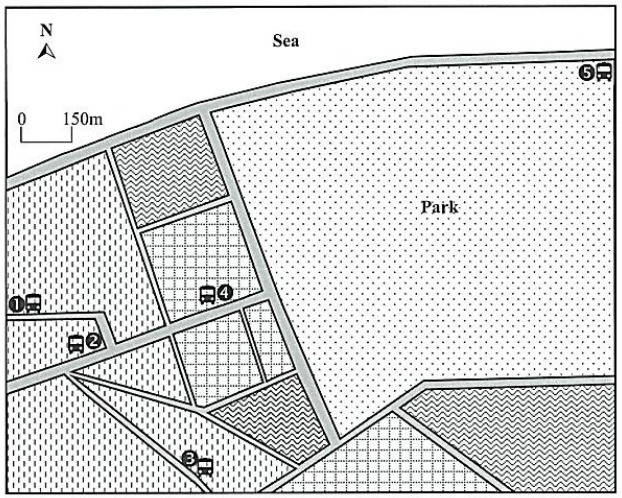
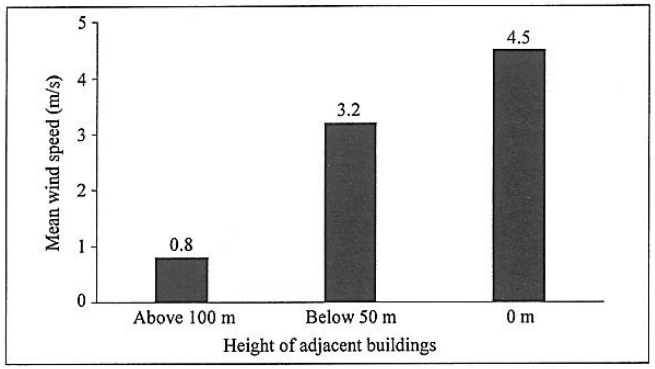
Field study topic	A comparison study of the impact of different building heights on wind speed
Field study area	 Key: Building height below 50m; Building height between 51m-100m; Building height above 100m; Road; Sampling point; Bus stop
Procedures of data collection	(1) Students are divided into 5 groups. (2) Each group chooses one sampling point close to a bus stop on their own. (3) Students use an anemometer to measure the wind speed of each sampling point at an interval of 15 minutes for one hour. (4) All groups would collect data at the sampling points at the same time.

Table 1b

		Sampling point				
		1	2	3	4	5
Height of adjacent buildings		Above 100m	Above 100m	Above 100m	Below 50m	0m
Time	15:00	0.9 m/s	1.0 m/s	0.7 m/s	2.5 m/s	4.8 m/s
	15:15	0.7 m/s	1.1 m/s	0.7 m/s	4.0 m/s	5.4 m/s
	15:30	0.8 m/s	1.0 m/s	0.5 m/s	3.4 m/s	4.2 m/s
	15:45	0.8 m/s	0.9 m/s	0.5 m/s	2.9 m/s	3.6 m/s

Figure 1c



Section B – Question 1

Popularity – 4%

1. A class of students carried out a geography field study on the wind speed in an urban area. Figure 1a shows some guidelines for the field study. Table 1b shows the wind speed data collected at the sampling points. Figure 1c is the graphical representation of the collected data shown in

(a) Refer to Figure 1a. Describe and explain why the field study area is suitable for this geographical investigation. (3 marks) **Fair**

(b) Refer to Figure 1a.

(i) Identify the sampling method in selecting the sampling points. Explain your answer. (2 marks) **Poor**

(ii) State the merits and demerits of the sampling method in (b)(i) in selecting the sampling points. (3 marks) **Poor**

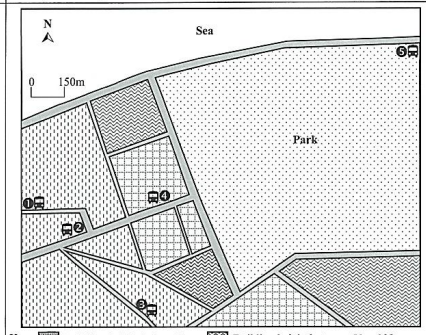
(c) Refer to Table 1b and Figure 1c.

(i) Describe how the collected data was processed and presented graphically as shown in Figure 1c. (3 marks) **Fair**

(ii) Draw a conclusion for the field study. (1 mark) **Good**

(d) Refer to the Figure 1a and Table 1b. Suggest other primary data to be collected to enrich the wind speed study at the existing sampling points. Describe and explain how the data would be collected. (6 marks) **Poor**

Figure 1a

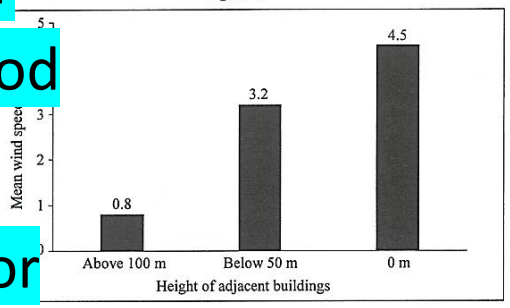
Field study topic	A comparison study of the impact of different building heights on wind speed
Field study area	

(1) Students are divided into 5 groups.
(2) Each group chooses one sampling point close to a bus stop on their own.
(3) Students use an anemometer to measure the wind speed of each sampling point at an interval of 15 minutes for one hour.
(4) All groups would collect data at the sampling points at the same time.

Table 1b

	Sampling point				
	1	2	3	4	5
	Above 100m	Above 100m	Above 100m	Below 50m	0m
15:00	0.9 m/s	1.0 m/s	0.7 m/s	2.5 m/s	4.8 m/s
15:15	0.7 m/s	1.1 m/s	0.7 m/s	4.0 m/s	5.4 m/s
15:30	0.8 m/s	1.0 m/s	0.5 m/s	3.4 m/s	4.2 m/s
15:45	0.8 m/s	0.9 m/s	0.5 m/s	2.9 m/s	3.6 m/s

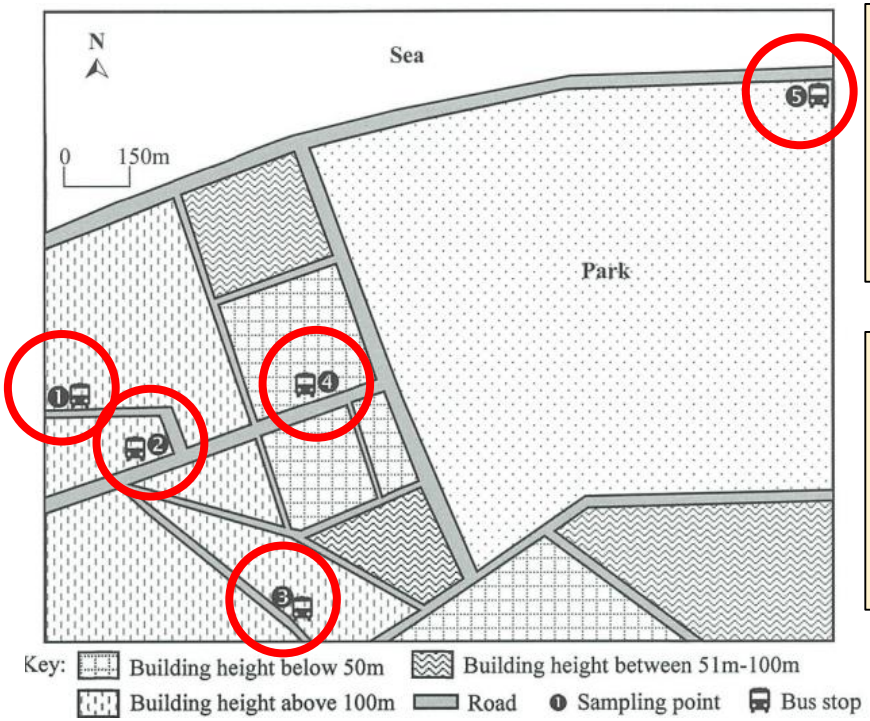
Figure 1c



Section B – Question 1

(a) Refer to Figure 1a. Describe and explain why the field study area is suitable for this geographical investigation. (3 marks)

Fair



- ✓ pointed out high accessibility
- ➢ Some failed to point out the high concentration of buildings with different heights

- ➢ wrong spelling
- ➢ wrong sampling method
- ➢ irrelevant content: the merits and the demerits of the sampling area

(b) (i) Identify the sampling method in selecting the sampling points. Explain your answer. (2 marks)

convenience sampling

(ii) State the merits and demerits of the sampling method in (b)(i) in selecting the sampling points. (3 marks)

Poor

Pay attention to the question words

Section B – Question 1

Table 1b

		Sampling point				
		1	2	3	4	5
Height of adjacent buildings		Above 100m	Above 100m	Above 100m	Below 50m	0m
Time	15:00	0.9 m/s	1.0 m/s	0.7 m/s	2.5 m/s	4.8 m/s
	15:15	0.7 m/s	1.1 m/s	0.7 m/s	4.0 m/s	5.4 m/s
	15:30	0.8 m/s	1.0 m/s	0.5 m/s	3.4 m/s	4.2 m/s
	15:45	0.8 m/s	0.9 m/s	0.5 m/s	2.9 m/s	3.6 m/s

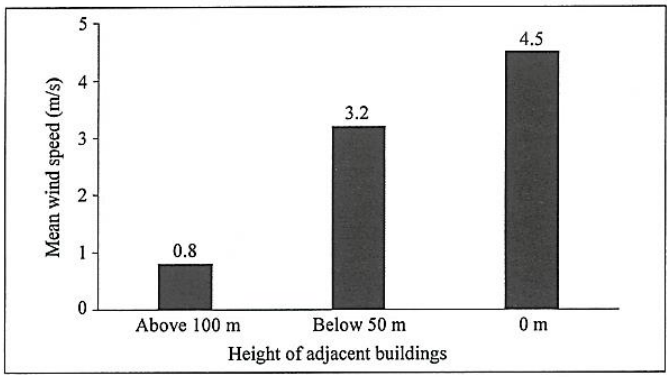
Procedure for calculating the mean value:

1. Mean of each point

2. Categories the points

3. Mean of buildings >100m

Figure 1c



- ✓ briefly described the procedure of handling the collected data
- ➢ incorrectly described the procedure for calculating the mean value

(c) Refer to Table 1b and Figure 1c.

(i) Describe how the collected data was processed and presented graphically as shown in Figure 1c. (3 marks)

(ii) Draw a conclusion for the field study. (1 mark) ✓

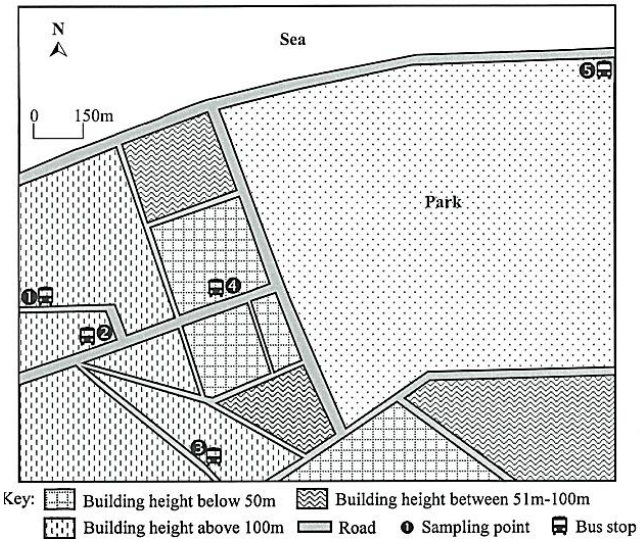
Fair

Good

Section B – Question 1

(d) Refer to the Figure 1a and Table 1b. Suggest other primary data to be collected to enrich the wind speed study at the existing sampling points. Describe and explain how the data would be collected. (6 marks)

Poor



- ✓ able to suggest some items for data collection, e.g. wind direction, the space between buildings
- ➢ failed to explain the methods and reasons for collecting other relevant primary data in detail
- ➢ irrelevant suggestions, e.g.
  - temperature and relative humidity
  - increasing the time of collecting wind speed data
  - increasing the number of sampling points

Table 1b

		Sampling point				
		1	2	3	4	5
Height of adjacent buildings		Above 100m	Above 100m	Above 100m	Below 50m	0m
Time	15:00	0.9 m/s	1.0 m/s	0.7 m/s	2.5 m/s	4.8 m/s
	15:15	0.7 m/s	1.1 m/s	0.7 m/s	4.0 m/s	5.4 m/s
	15:30	0.8 m/s	1.0 m/s	0.5 m/s	3.4 m/s	4.2 m/s
	15:45	0.8 m/s	0.9 m/s	0.5 m/s	2.9 m/s	3.6 m/s

Pay attention to the question words

Section B – Question 2

2. Figure 2a shows the major spatial distribution of tectonic landform X. Figure 2b shows the epicentres of earthquakes and the locations of some major cities in country Y. Table 2c shows the information regarding tectonic hazards which have occurred in country Y. Table 2d shows the actions taken by the government of country Y in response to the tectonic hazards in 2010.

Figure 2a

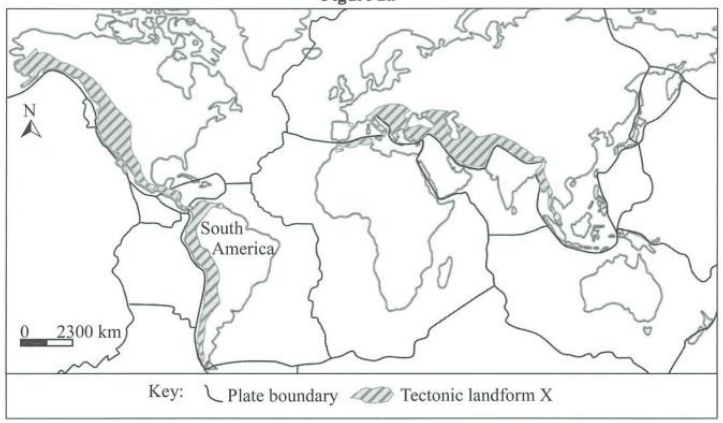


Figure 2b

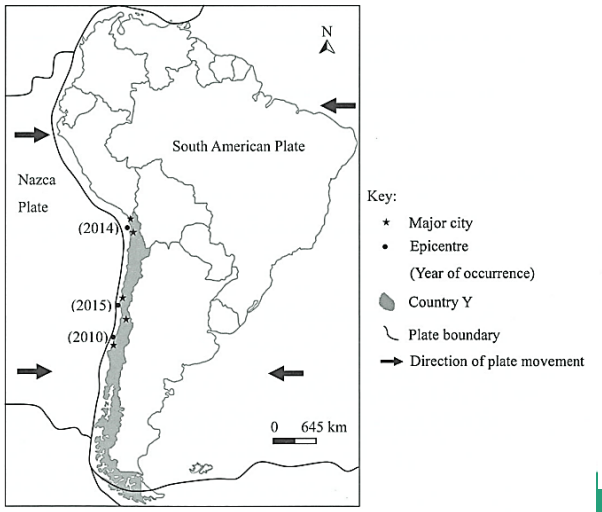


Table 2c

Year of occurrence	Total death toll	Tsunami-related death toll	The magnitude (Richter Scale)	Depth of focus (km)	Time of occurrence (local time)	Highest wave height of tsunami (m)
2010	521	156	8.8	35	3:34 am	29
2014	7	0	8.2	20	8:46 pm	4.6
2015	15	0	8.3	22.4	7:54 pm	4.5

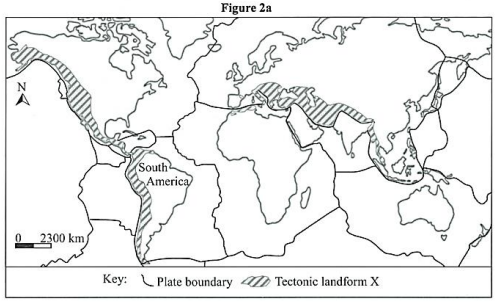
Table 2d

Year	Actions taken by the government
Since 2010	Conducted larger-scale earthquake and tsunami evacuation drills regularly
	Enhanced earthquake-resistant building standards
	Increased the speed of real-time data transmission of tsunami buoy sensors
	Increased the number of regional tsunami monitoring stations

Section B – Question 2 Popularity – 86%

2. Figure 2a shows the major spatial distribution of tectonic landform X. Figure 2b shows the epicentres of earthquakes and the locations of some major cities in country Y. Table 2c shows the information regarding tectonic hazards which have occurred in country Y. Table 2d shows the actions taken by the government of country Y in response to the tectonic hazards in 2010.

Figure 2a



(a) Refer to Figures 2a and 2b.

(i) Identify tectonic landform X. (1 mark)

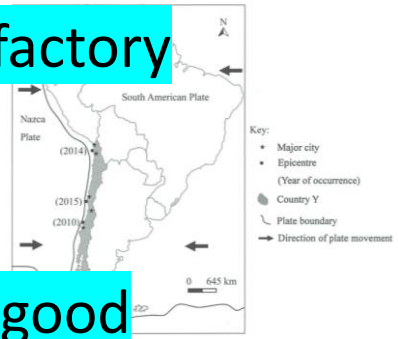
(ii) Draw a series of annotated diagrams to explain the formation of tectonic landform X in South America. (5 marks)

(iii) Explain why earthquakes and tsunamis are common in country Y. (4 marks)

Satisfactory

Fair

Very good



(b) Refer to Figure 2b and Table 2c. Explain the high death toll of country Y in the 2010 tsunami. (4 marks)

Good

Table 2c

	Total toll	Tsunami-related death toll	The magnitude (Richter Scale)	Depth of focus (km)	Time of occurrence (local time)	Highest wave height of tsunami (m)
2010	521	156	8.8	35	3:34 am	29
2014	7	0	8.2	20	8:46 pm	4.6
2015	15	0	8.3	22.4	7:54 pm	4.5

(c) Refer to Figure 2b, Table 2c and Table 2d. Discuss whether the actions taken by the government allow higher-density development along the coastal area of country Y. (4 marks)

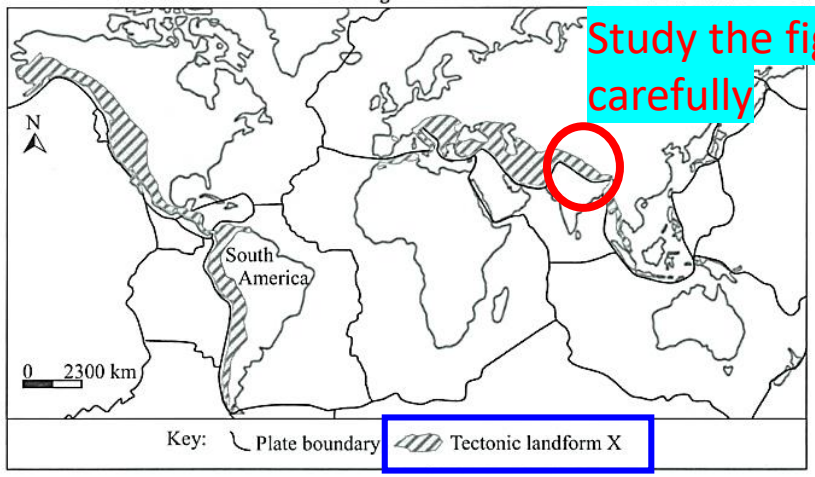
Fair

Table 2d

Year	Actions taken by the government
	Conducted larger-scale earthquake and tsunami evacuation drills regularly
	Enhanced earthquake-resistant building standards
	Increased the speed of real-time data transmission of tsunami buoy sensors
	Increased the number of regional tsunami monitoring stations

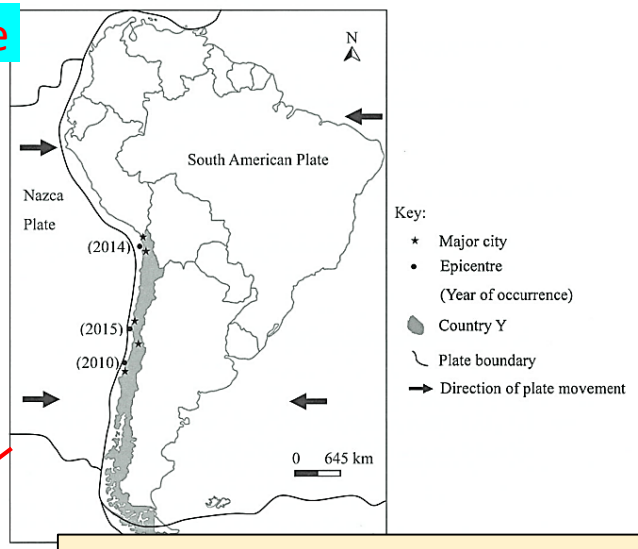
Section B – Question 2

Figure 2a



Study the figure carefully

Figure 2b



Pay attention to the question words

(a) Refer to Figures 2a and 2b.

(i) Identify tectonic landform X. (1 mark)

(ii) Draw a series of annotated diagrams to explain the formation of tectonic landform X in South America. (5 marks)

(iii) Explain why earthquakes and tsunamis are common in country Y. (4 marks)

Satisfactory

- ✓ Most could identify landform X
- ➢ Some wrongly identified landforms, e.g. volcanoes
- ➢ irrelevant answers, e.g. destructive plate boundary
- ➢ failed to write fold mountain correctly

Section B – Question 2

Figure 2a

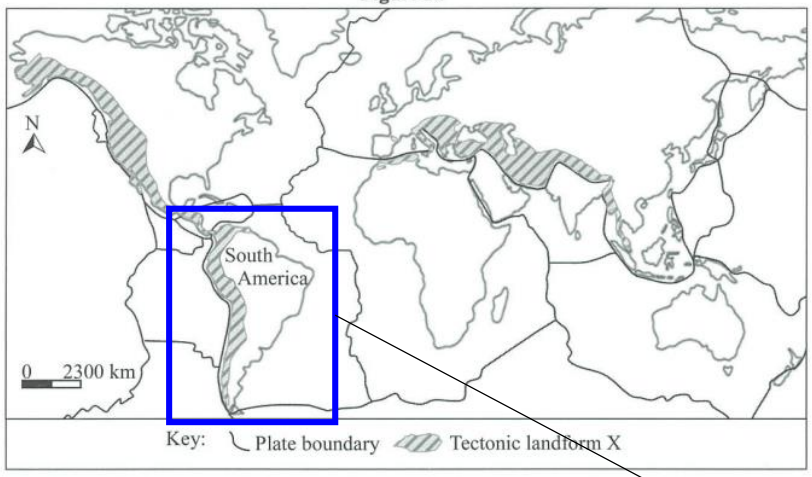
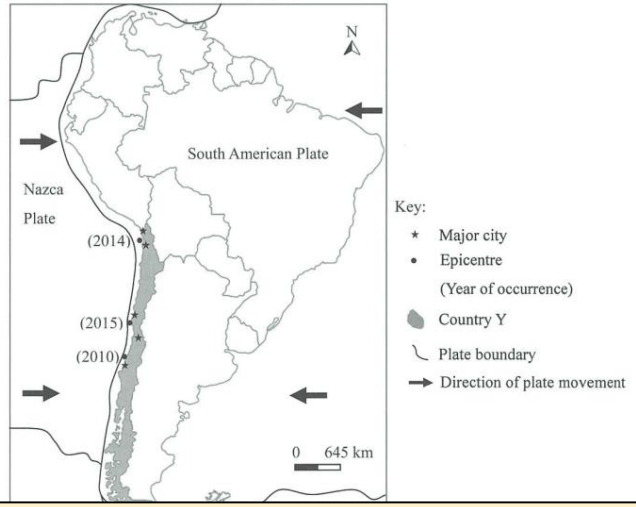


Figure 2b



(a) Refer to Figures 2a and 2b.

(i) Identify tectonic landform X. Fair rk)

(ii) Draw a series of annotated diagrams to explain the formation of tectonic landform X in South America. (5 marks)

Labels for each part of an image

- ✓ able to draw diagrams illustrating the stages of plate processes (convergence, subduction, folding and uplift in sedimentary rocks)
- ➢ incorrectly drew the location of uplifted sedimentary rocks
- ➢ wrote paragraphs about the formation next to the drawings without any annotations

Section B – Question 2

Figure 2a

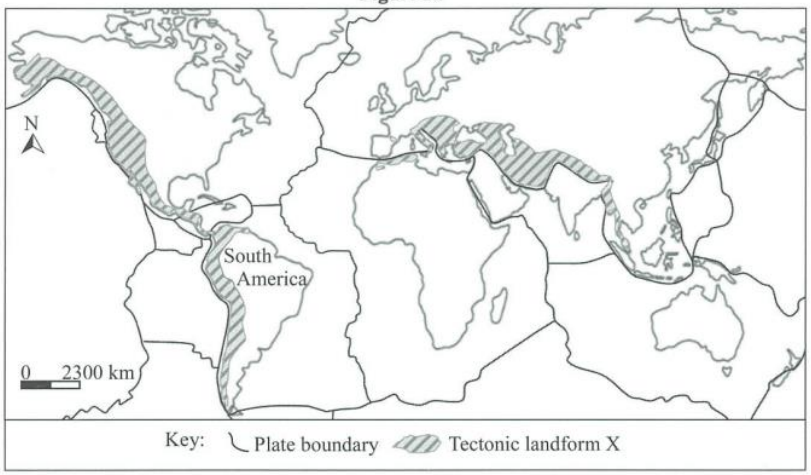
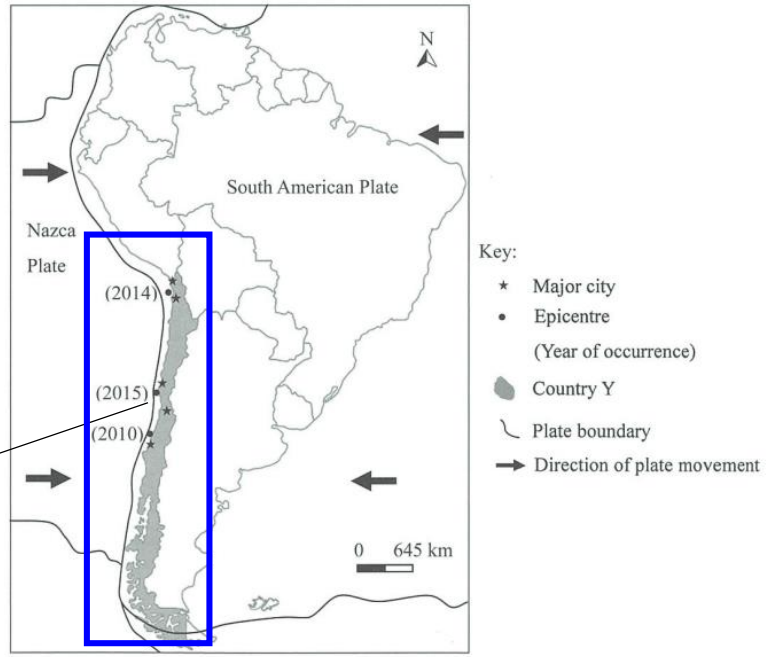


Figure 2b



(a) Refer to Figures 2a and 2b.

(iii) Explain why earthquakes and tsunamis are common in country Y. (4 marks)

Very good

- ✓ a clear understanding of the formation of earthquakes and tsunamis along a subduction zone
- ➢ failed to explain how tsunamis were induced by submarine earthquakes
- ➢ irrelevant content: coastal landslides and submarine volcanic eruptions

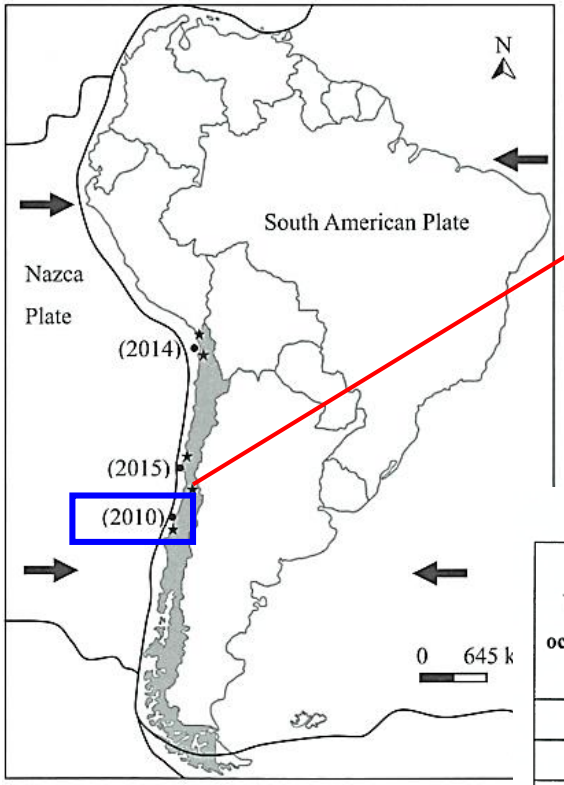
Section B – Question 2

(b) Refer to Figure 2b and Table 2c. Explain the high death toll of country Y in the 2010 tsunami. (4 marks)

Good

☑Data interpretation
☒Data duplication

Figure 2b



- ✓ able to explain the high death toll with evidence provided, e.g. intensity and occurrence time of the earthquake
- ➢ inaccurate descriptions: quoting data only, strong earthquakes and big waves
- ➢ inadequate understanding: e.g.
  - the amount of energy released by an earthquake

Table 2c

Year of occurrence	Total death toll	Tsunami-related death toll	The magnitude (Richter Scale)	Depth of focus (km)	Time of occurrence (local time)	Highest wave height of tsunami (m)
2010	521	156	8.8	35	3:34 am	29
2014	7	0	8.2	20	8:46 pm	4.6
2015	15	0	8.3	22.4	7:54 pm	4.5

Section B – Question 2

(c) Refer to Figure 2b, Table 2c and Table 2d. Discuss whether the actions taken by the government allow higher-density development along the coastal area of country Y. (4 marks)

Fair

- ✓ a brief explanation of the possibility of higher-density development in Y
- ✓ quoting evidence to support argument, e.g. low death toll in 2014 and 2015
- ➢ irrelevant content: poverty, low level of technology, political instability
- ➢ failed to consider the availability of land in country Y for further development

Figure 2b

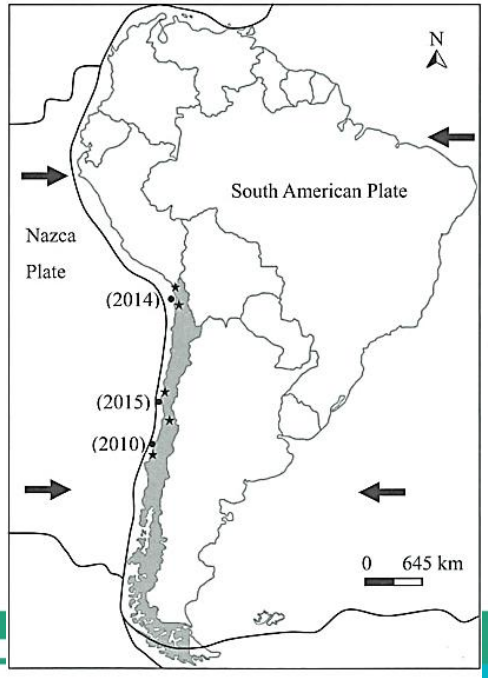


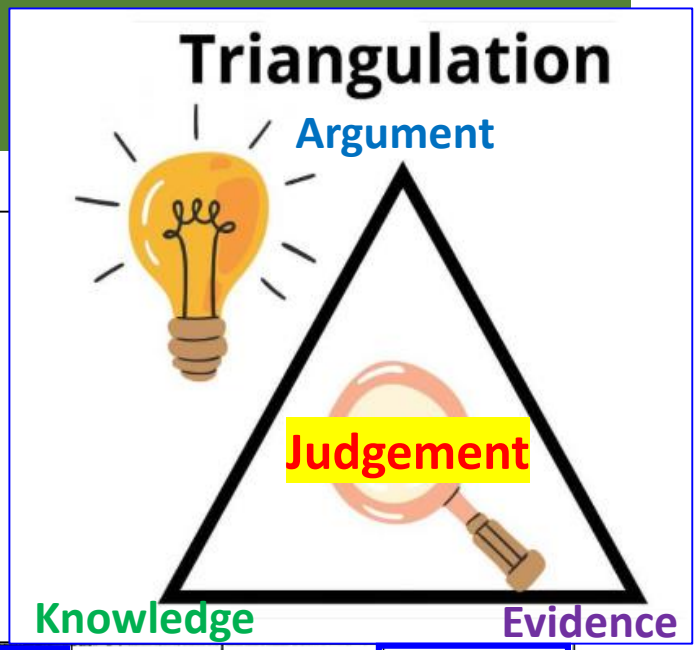
Table 2c

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2014	7	0	8.2	20	8:46 pm	4.6
2015	15	0	8.3	22.4	7:54 pm	4.5

Table 2d

Year	Actions taken by the government
Since 2010	Conducted larger-scale earthquake and tsunami evacuation drills regularly
	Enhanced earthquake-resistant building standards
	Increased the speed of real-time data transmission of tsunami buoy sensors
	Increased the number of regional tsunami monitoring stations

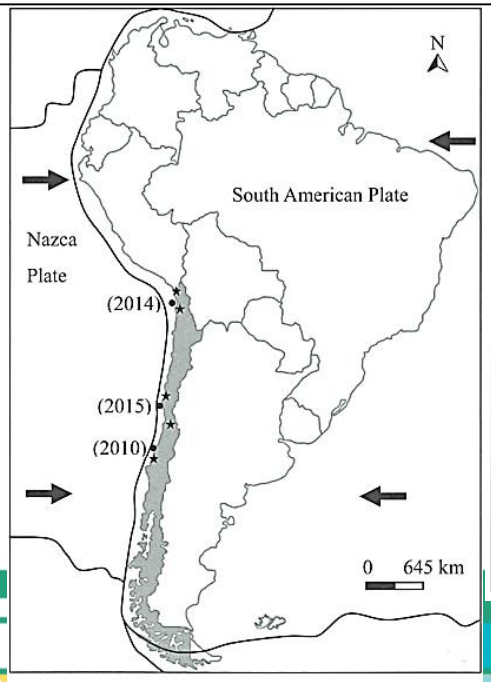
Section B – Question 2



Marking criteria :

Logical and well-elaborated explanation/argument with reference to the information provided, demonstrating good knowledge and understanding of the actions taken by the government of Y

With appropriate judgement



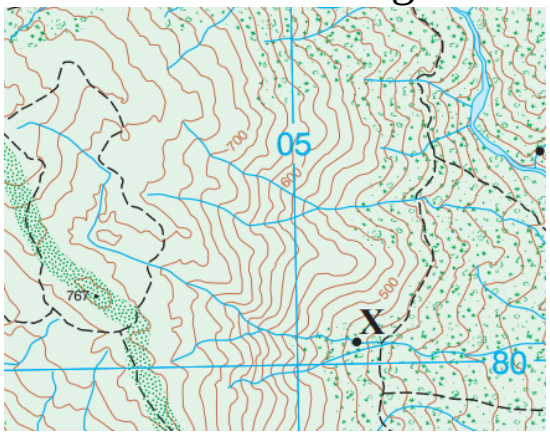
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Table 2d

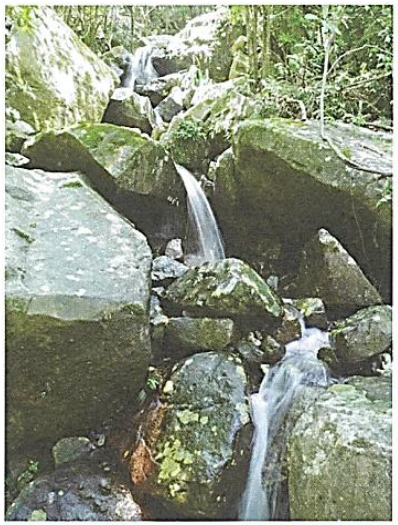
Year	Actions taken by the government
Since 2010	Conducted larger-scale earthquake and tsunami evacuation drills regularly
	Enhanced earthquake-resistant building standards
	Increased the speed of real-time data transmission of tsunami buoy sensors
	Increased the number of regional tsunami monitoring stations

Section B – Question 3

3. Refer to the map extract (1:20 000) of Hong Kong, which shows part of Sha Tin district. Photograph 3a shows the river channel at site X (051800). Photograph 3b shows fluvial landform feature Y at 056805. Figure 3c shows the simplified map of a section of Shing Mun River in 1970.



Photograph 3a



Photograph 3b

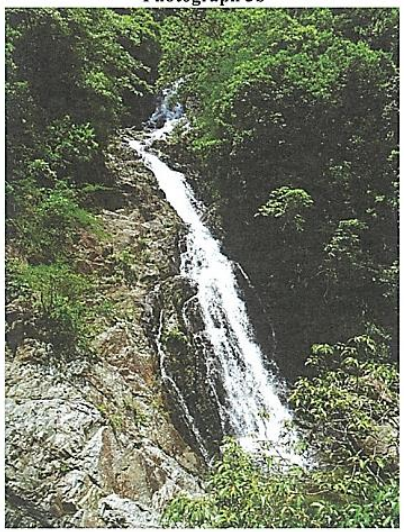
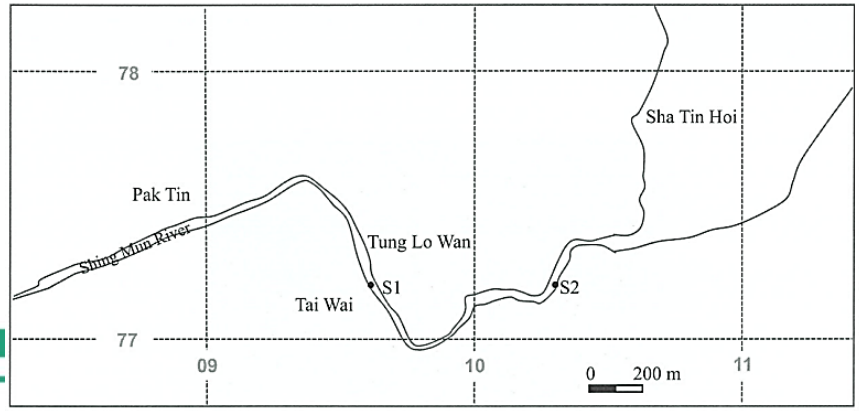


Figure 3c



Section B – Question 3 Popularity – 36%

3. Refer to the map extract (1:20 000) of Hong Kong, which shows part of Sha Tin district. Photograph 3a shows the river channel at site X (051800). Photograph 3b shows fluvial landform feature Y at 056805. Figure 3c shows the simplified map of a section of Shing Mun River in 1970.

(a) Refer to Photograph 3a and the map extract (1:20 000) of Hong Kong.

(i) Identify the river course at site X. (1 mark) Very good

(ii) Describe the channel characteristics at site X. Support your answer with map and photo evidence. (4 marks) Satisfactory

(b) Refer to Photograph 3b and the map extract (1:20 000) of Hong Kong.

With reference to the characteristics of fluvial landform feature Y, why is it not appropriate for promoting water-friendly activities? (4 marks) Very good

(c) Refer to Figure 3c and the map extract (1:20 000) of Hong Kong.

(i) Describe and explain how the section of Shing Mun River from S1 (0977) to S2 (1077) has been modified to prevent flooding. (5 marks) Good

(ii) *There is an increasing risk of severe flooding in Hong Kong.*

Discuss whether building underground stormwater storage tanks is more appropriate than further channel modification to prevent the flooding of Shing Mun River. (4 marks) Poor

Section B – Question 3

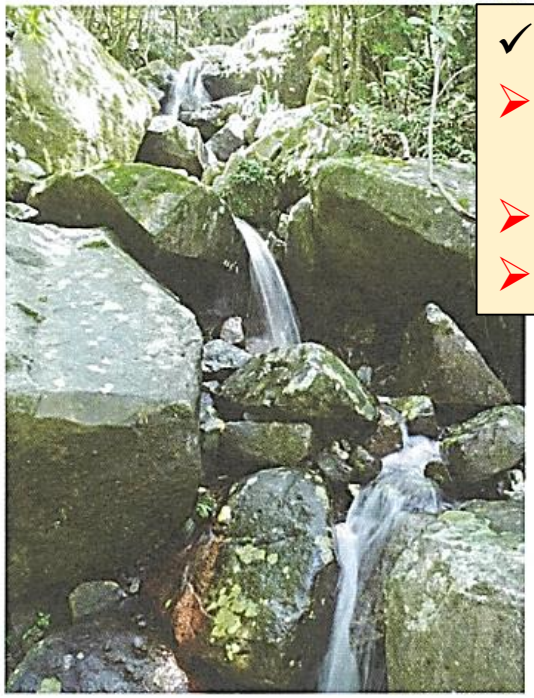
(a) Refer to Photograph 3a and the map extract (1:20 000) of Hong Kong.

(i) Identify the river course at site X. (1 mark) ✓ Very good

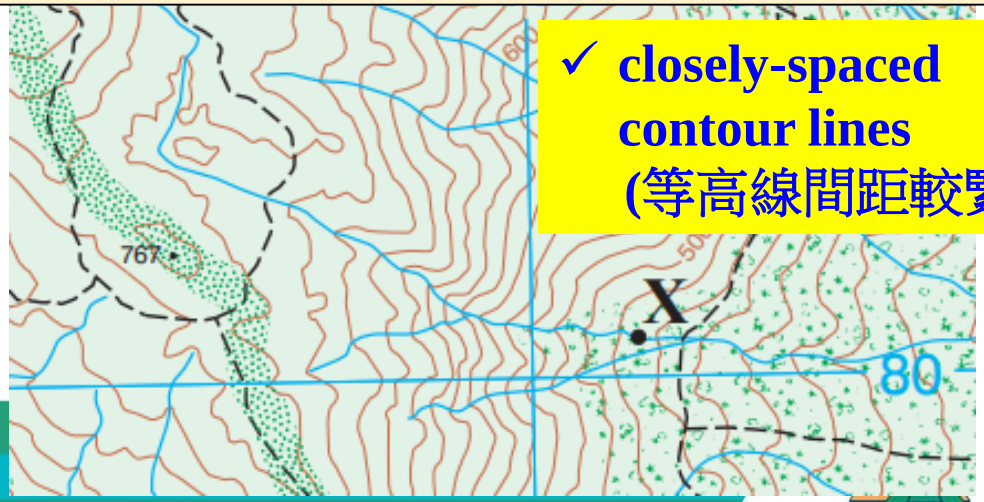
(ii) Describe the channel characteristics at site X. Support your answer with map and photo evidence. (4 marks) Satisfactory

Evidence + description

Photograph 3a



- ✓ stated some correct channel characteristics, e.g. steep
- ➢ correct evidence without corresponding description e.g. boulders (without description)
- ➢ wrong evidence, e.g. X was located >500m
- ➢ inaccurate geographical terms, e.g. denser contour lines

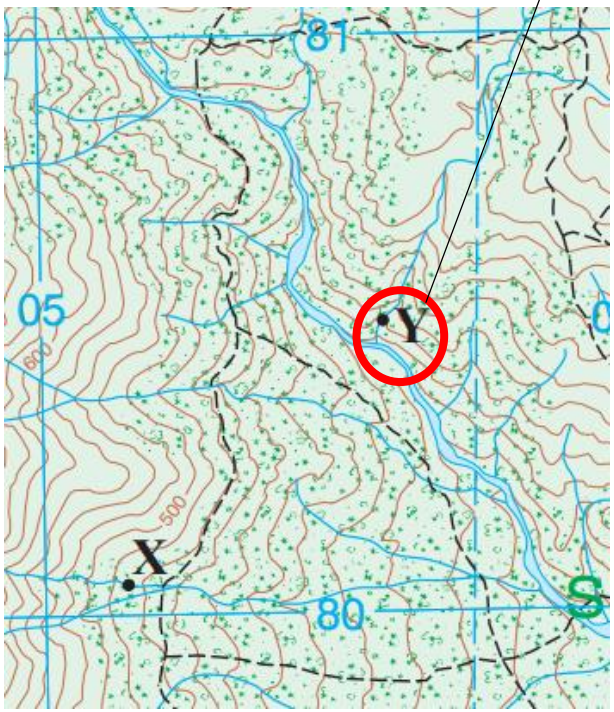


✓ **closely-spaced contour lines (等高線間距較緊密)**

Section B – Question 3

(b) Refer to Photograph 3b and the map extract (1:20 000) of Hong Kong. With reference to the characteristics of fluvial landform feature Y, why is it not appropriate for promoting water-friendly activities? (4 marks)

Very good

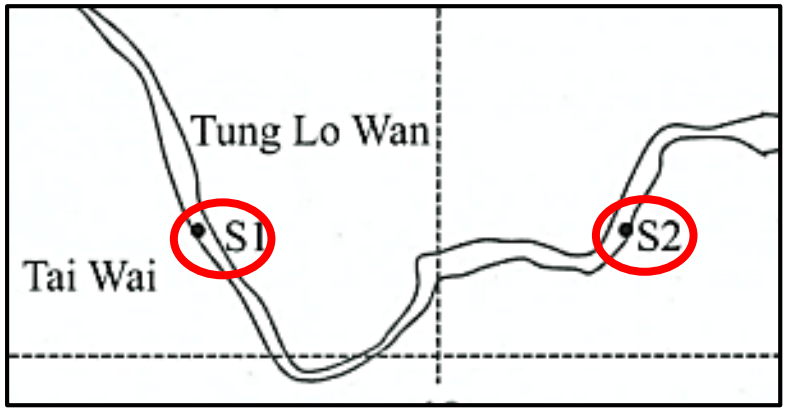


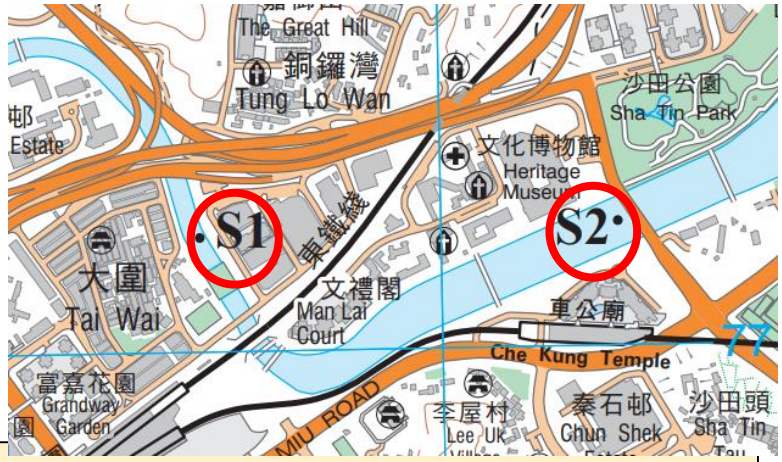


- ✓ identified 'waterfall'
- ✓ explained the potential risk of promoting water-friendly activities regarding the characteristics of fluvial landform feature Y
- ➢ irrelevant content: low accessibility and remoteness

Pay attention to the question words

Section B – Question 3





- ✓ most correctly identified 'channelisation'
- ✓ most gave appropriate descriptions and corresponding explanations, e.g. 'widen the river channel' and 'increase water-holding capacity'
- ➢ some gave inaccurate description, e.g. 'deepening the river channel' and 'covering the bed with concrete'

Read the information more carefully

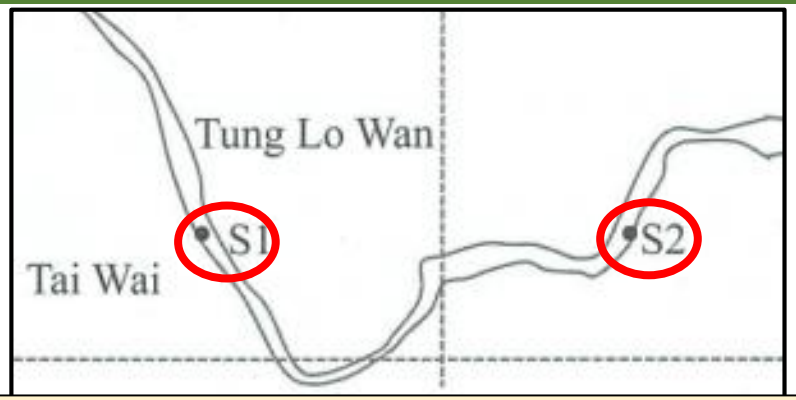
(c) Refer to Figure 3c and the map extract (1:20 000) of Hong Kong.

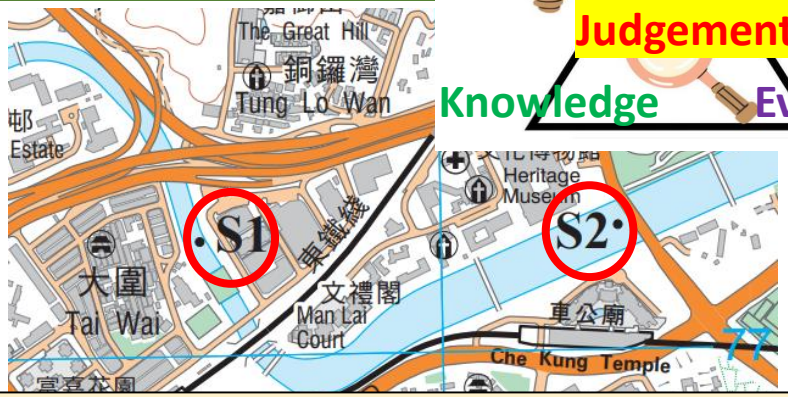
(i) Describe and explain how the section of Shing Mun River from S1 (0977) to S2 (1077) has been modified to prevent flooding. (5 marks)

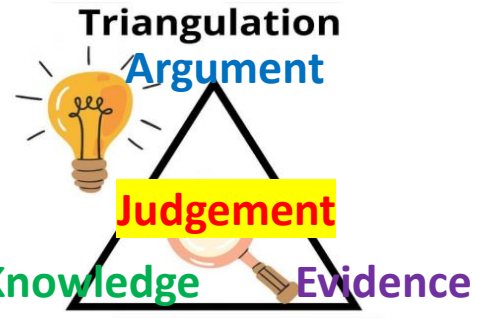
Good

(ii) *There is an increasing risk of severe flooding in Hong Kong.*
Discuss whether building underground stormwater storage tanks is more appropriate than further channel modification to prevent the flooding of Shing Mun River. (4 marks)

Section B – Question 3







- ✓ most provided a brief explanation of the pros and/or limitations of the 2 strategies
- ✓ some gave a logical argument with reference to the information provided, e.g. land availability and level of development
- ➢ inadequate understanding: underground stormwater storage tanks, 'further' channel modification
- ➢ commonly lacked justification
- ➢ irrelevant content: 'visual pollution', 'limited underground space'

(c) Refer to Figure 3c and the map extract (1:20 000) of Hong Kong.

(ii) *There is an increasing risk of severe flooding in Hong Kong.*

Discuss whether building underground stormwater storage tanks is more appropriate than further channel modification to prevent the flooding of Shing Mun River. (4 marks)

Poor

Section B – Question 4

4. Photograph 4a shows the landscape of the innovation district in Boston, the U.S.. Figure 4b shows information about Boston. Table 4c shows the information about the production and sales of smartphone company X. Table 4d shows the socio-economic information about India and the U.S. in 2022.

Photograph 4a



Table 4c

		Country			
Component manufacturing	(i) camera lens	Japan			
	(ii) processor	The U.S.			
	(iii) chip	The Netherlands			
Assembling process		India			
Share of sales revenue (%)		The U.S.	Germany	China	India
		46	27	19	8

Figure 4b

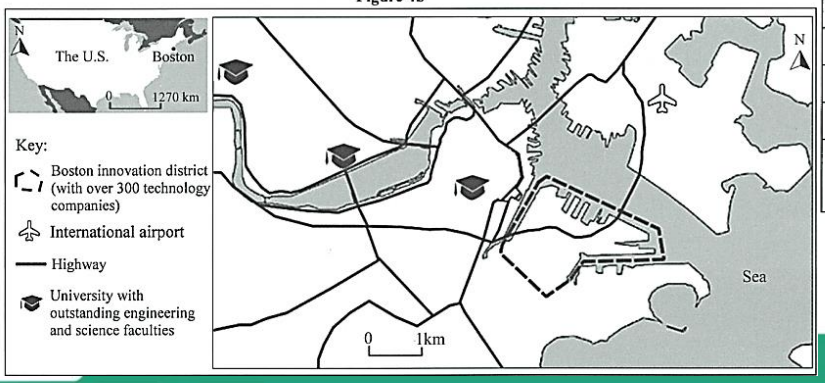


Table 4d

	India	The U.S.
Population (billion)	1.4	0.3
Population with tertiary education (%)	12.9	50.0
GDP growth rate (%)	7	2
GDP per capita (USD)	2 390	75 260
Average hourly wages in manufacturing sector (USD)	2.7	26.2
Government policy since 2018	Refined labour protection laws	Reduced corporate tax rate from 35% to 21%

Section B – Question 4 Popularity – 82%

4. Photograph 4a shows the landscape of the innovation district in Boston, the U.S.. Figure 4b shows information about Boston. Table 4c shows the information about the production and sales of smartphone company X. Table 4d shows the socio-economic information about India and the U.S. in 2022.

(a) Refer to Photograph 4a. Describe the industrial landscape of the innovation district. (2 marks) Fair

(b) Refer to Figure 4b. Apart from the industrial landscape in (a), account for the locational factors that attract company X to set up its headquarters in the innovation district. Support your answer with evidence. (6 marks) Good

(c) Refer to Table 4c. With reference to the characteristics of the components, explain why different components are produced in different countries. (6 marks) Poor

(d) *Company X has decided to adopt a higher level of automation in the assembling process.*
Refer to Tables 4c and 4d. Discuss whether company X will relocate the assembling process back to the U.S.. (4 marks) Fair

Section B – Question 4



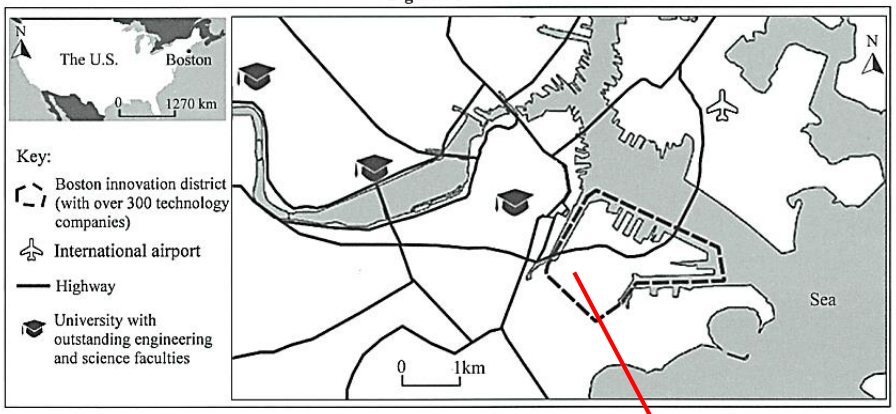
(a) Refer to Photograph 4a. Describe the industrial landscape of the innovation district. (2 marks) Fair

- ✓ accurately described the industrial landscape, e.g. greenfield site, spacious
- ➢ inaccurate description: confused green belt with greening
- ➢ irrelevant description: new building design

Section B – Question 4



Figure 4b



(b) Refer to Figure 4b. Apart from the industrial landscape in (a), account for the locational factors that attract company X to set up its headquarters in the innovation district. Support your answer with evidence. (6 marks)

Good

- ✓ correctly stated the locational advantages with corresponding evidence, e.g. abundant supply of professionals + universities nearby
- ➢ inaccurate quotation of the evidence
  e.g. 'there were universities', 'there was an airport'
- ➢ misunderstanding of the role of headquarters
  e.g. manufacturing goods for exports
- ➢ evidence with wrong reasons
  e.g. coastal location + favourable for import raw materials

Evidence + Reason

Section B – Question 4

(c) Refer to Table 4c. With reference to the characteristics of the components, explain why different components are produced in different countries. (6 marks)

Poor

Table 4c

		Country			
Component manufacturing	(i) camera lens	Japan			
	(ii) processor	The U.S.			
	(iii) chip	The Netherlands			
Assembling process		India			
Share of sales revenue (%)		The U.S.	Germany	China	India
		46	27	19	8

Read the question more carefully
Pay attention to the question words

- ✓ able to identify the production mode
- ✓ able to identify the components manufacturing in MDCs
- ➢ failed to explain comprehensively the production of high-end components in **different** MDCs
- ➢ irrelevant content: assembling process in India

Section B – Question 4

Table 4c

		Country			
Component manufacturing	(i) camera lens	Japan			
	(ii) processor	The U.S.			
	(iii) chip	The Netherlands			
Assembling process		India			
Share of sales revenue (%)		The U.S.	Germany	China	India
		46	27	19	8

Table 4d

	India	The U.S.
Population (billion)	1.4	0.3
Population with tertiary education (%)	12.9	50.0
GDP growth rate (%)	7	2
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Average hourly wages in manufacturing sector (USD)	2.7	26.2
Government policy since 2018	Refined labour protection laws	Reduced corporate tax rate from 35% to 21%

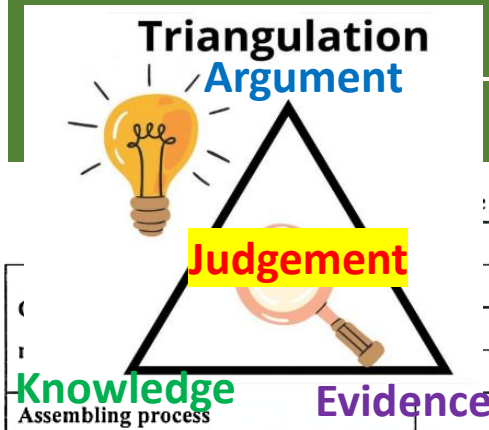
- ✓ Some briefly highlighted the significance of labour quality and technological level
- ➢ inadequate understanding of the influence of automation on the assembling process
- ➢ irrelevant content: amount of cheap labour supply

(d) *Company X has decided to adopt a higher level of automation in the assembling process.*

Refer to Tables 4c and 4d. Discuss whether company X will relocate the assembling process back to the U.S.. (4 marks)

Fair

– Question 4



Country
Japan
The U.S.
The Netherlands
India

Assembling process	The U.S.	Germany	China	India
Share of sales revenue (%)	46	27	19	8

Table 4d

	India	The U.S.
Population (billion)	1.4	0.3
Population with tertiary education (%)	12.9	50.0
GDP growth rate (%)	7	2
GDP per capita (USD)	2 390	75 260
Average hourly wages in manufacturing sector (USD)	2.7	26.2
Government policy since 2018	Refined labour protection laws	Reduced corporate tax rate from 35% to 21%

- ✓ Some briefly highlighted the significance of labour quality and technological level
- ➢ inadequate understanding of the influence of automation on the assembling process
- ➢ irrelevant content: amount of cheap labour supply

(d) *Company X has decided to adopt a higher level of automation in the assembling process.*
Refer to Tables 4c and 4d. Discuss whether company X will relocate the assembling process back to the U.S.. (4 marks)

Section B – Question 4

4. Photograph 4a shows the landscape of the innovation district in Boston, the U.S.. Figure 4b shows information about Boston. Table 4c shows the information about the production and sales of smartphone company X. Table 4d shows the socio-economic information about India and the U.S. in 2022.

(a) Refer to Photograph 4a. Describe the industrial landscape of the innovation district. (2 marks)

(b) Refer to Figure 4b. Apart from the industrial landscape in (a), account for the locational factors that attract company X to set up its headquarters in the innovation district. Support your answer with evidence. (6 marks)

(c) Refer to Table 4c. With reference to the characteristics of the components, explain why different components are produced in different countries. (6 marks)

(d) *Company X has decided to adopt a higher level of automation in the assembling process.*
Refer to Tables 4c and 4d. Discuss whether company X will relocate the assembling process back to the U.S..(4 marks)

Pay attention to the question words

Section B – Question 5

5. Table 5a shows the area of deforestation in the Brazilian Amazon between 2012 and 2020. Figure 5b shows the number of cattle and the amount of beef exports in Brazil between 2012 and 2020. Figure 5c shows cattle ranching activities in the Brazilian Amazon.

Table 5a

Year	Area of deforestation in the Brazilian Amazon (km^2)
2012	4 571
2014	5 012
2016	7 893
2018	7 536
2020	10 951

Figure 5b

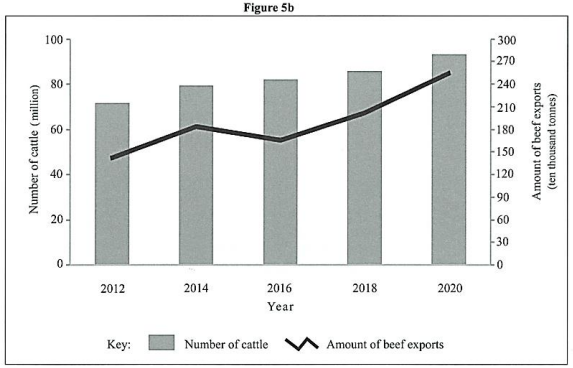


Figure 5c



Section B – Question 5 Popularity – 91%

5. Table 5a shows the area of deforestation in the Brazilian Amazon between 2012 and 2020. Figure 5b shows the number of cattle and the amount of beef exports in Brazil between 2012 and 2020. Figure 5c shows cattle ranching activities in the Brazilian Amazon.

(a) Refer to Table 5a and Figure 5b.

(i) Calculate the overall percentage change regarding the area of deforestation of the Brazilian Amazon between 2012 and 2020. Describe the trend. (2 marks) Excellent

(ii) Explain the trend in (a)(i). (4 marks) Satisfactory

(b) Refer to Figure 5c. Explain the impact of cattle ranching on

(i) the soil in both the short term and the long term, and (5 marks) Satisfactory

(ii) the food chain (3 marks) Fair

in the deforested area.

(c) *Remote monitoring technology like satellites and drones reveals that there are illegal cattle ranching activities in the restricted area in the Brazilian Amazon.*

Refer to Table 5a, Figure 5b and Figure 5c. Discuss the effectiveness Poor of remote monitoring technology in helping the Brazilian government to control deforestation in the Amazon. (4 marks)

Section B – Question 5

(a) Refer to Table 5a and Figure 5b.

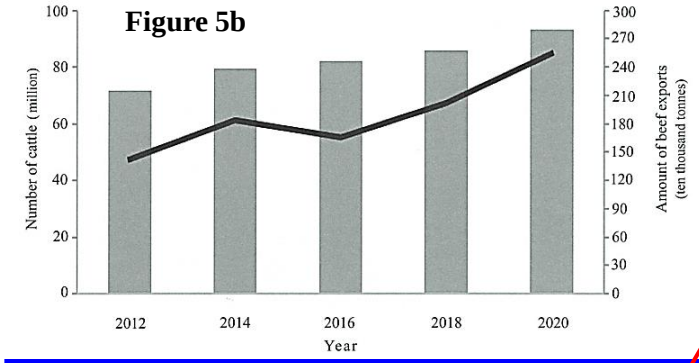
(i) Calculate the overall percentage change regarding the area of deforestation of the Brazilian Amazon between 2012 and 2020. Describe the trend. (2 marks)

(ii) Explain the trend in (a)(i). (4 marks)

Table 5a

Year	Area of deforestation in the Brazilian Amazon (km^2)
2012	4 571
2014	5 012
2016	7 893
2018	7 536
2020	10 951

Figure 5b



Excellent

- ✓ most correctly described
- ➢ some failed to calculate (139.6% / 140%)
- ➢ some failed to round off the decimal number

Satisfactory

- ✓ good use of the data
- ➢ failed to explain the causes of increasing amount of beef exports
- ➢ inadequate understanding of **global** demand for beef
- ➢ failed to state the relationship between the extensive farming practice of cattle ranching and the trend of deforestation

Section B – Question 5

(b) Refer to Figure 5c. Explain the impact of cattle ranching on

(i) the soil in both the short term and the long term, and (5 marks)

(ii) the food chain (3 marks)

in the deforested area.

Satisfactory

- ✓ gave a brief explanation of the impact on the soil in both:
  - the short term (burning for ash)
  - the long term (stronger soil erosion)
- ➢ some failed to differentiate between short-term and long-term impacts
- ➢ did not specify the time frame
- ➢ some failed to indicate the intensity of soil erosion in the long term

Pay attention to the question words

Figure 5c



Section B – Question 5

(b) Refer to Figure 5c. Explain the impact of cattle ranching on

(i) the soil in both the short term and the long term, and (5 marks)

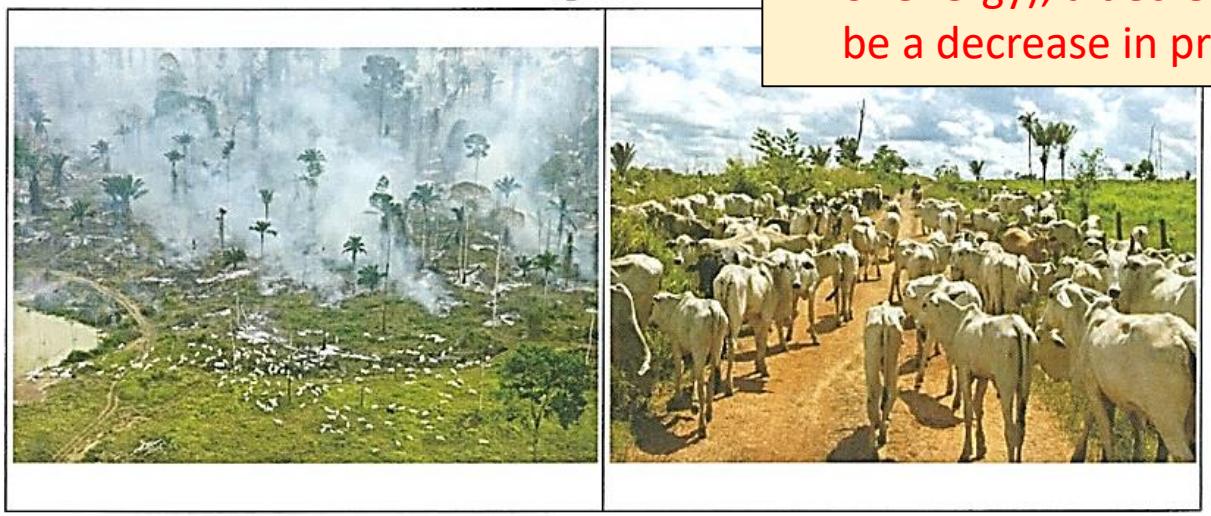
(ii) the food chain (3 marks)

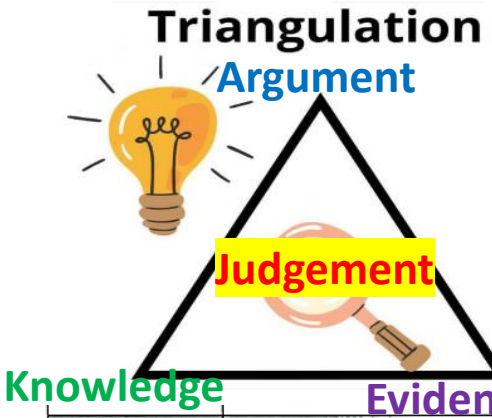
in the deforested area.

Fair

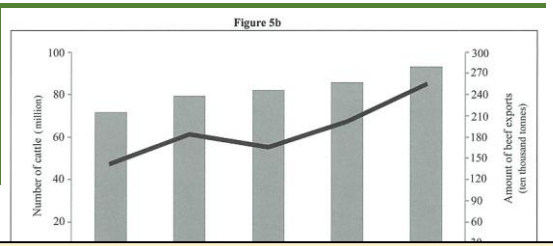
- ✓ a brief explanation of the impact on the food chain, e.g. shorter food chain
- ➢ inadequate understanding of the changes in energy flow in a food chain e.g. energy captured by producers↓
- ➢ confused food chain with food web, e.g. simplified food chain
- ➢ confused energy flow with nutrient cycle, e.g. nutrient loss (should be less supply of energy), a decrease in biomass (should be a decrease in producers)

Figure 5c





– Question 5



he Brazilian Amazo
571
012

2016	7 893
2018	7 536
2020	10 951

Figure 5c



Pay attention to the question words

- ✓ Some briefly explained the advantages of using remote monitoring technology, e.g. frequency
- ✓ Some highlighted the importance of law enforcement
- ➢ few recognised the large extent of the Brazilian Amazon as a limitation
- ➢ some failed to recognise:
  - the measure had been implemented
  - it was only applied to restricted areas
- ➢ irrelevant content: low level of technology, a lack of capital and government support

(c) *Remote monitoring technology like satellites and drones reveals that there are illegal cattle ranching activities in the restricted area in the Brazilian Amazon.*

Refer to Table 5a, Figure 5b and Figure 5c. Discuss the effectiveness of remote monitoring technology in helping the Brazilian government to control deforestation in the Amazon. (4 marks)

Poor

General comments and recommendations

**** Make good use of the information provided***

1. Candidates should not only copy the information provided. They should interpret the information and provide further elaboration.
2. When answering the open-ended questions, it is highly recommended to use the data provided to further illustrate the arguments.
3. Candidates should apply relevant knowledge to the situations stated in the questions.

Section C – Question 6

Popularity – 26%
Performance – Fair

Describe and explain the housing problems in the inner city areas of Hong Kong. Discuss whether redevelopment can resolve the housing problems in the inner city areas of Hong Kong.

Section C – Question 6

Describe and explain the housing problems in the inner city areas of Hong Kong. Discuss whether redevelopment can resolve the housing problems in the inner city areas of Hong Kong.

Part	Explanatory notes
1st	✓ demonstrated a basic understanding of the causes of housing problems in the inner city areas of Hong Kong ✓ able to state the housing problems with a brief description and explanation, e.g. - the long history of development of inner city areas - mixed land use - crowded living environment - insufficient community facilities

Section C – Question 6

Describe and explain the housing problems in the inner city areas of Hong Kong. Discuss whether redevelopment can resolve the housing problems in the inner city areas of Hong Kong.

Part	Explanatory notes
1st	➢ failed to explain in detail, e.g. how the outdated urban planning led to a lack of community facilities ➢ failed to explain a linkage between environmental problems (caused by mixed land use) and housing problems ➢ failed to explain how the keen land use competition (due to the proximity of inner city areas to the CBD) led to the housing problems

Section C – Question 6

Describe and explain the housing problems in the inner city areas of Hong Kong.
Discuss whether redevelopment can resolve the housing problems in the inner city areas of Hong Kong.

Part	Explanatory notes
2nd	✓ demonstrated a basic understanding of redevelopment ✓ briefly explained the effectiveness and limitations of redevelopment in solving the housing problems, e.g. building structural improvement, long duration of development

Section C – Question 6

Describe and explain the housing problems in the inner city areas of Hong Kong.
Discuss whether redevelopment can resolve the housing problems in the inner city areas of Hong Kong.

Part	Explanatory notes
2nd	➢ failed to state the constituents involved in redevelopment ➢ failed to discuss how the scale of redevelopment affected the effectiveness of redevelopment regarding the housing problems ➢ irrelevant content: e.g. 'redevelopment provides more commercial land use and job opportunities'

Section C – Question 7

Popularity – 50%
Performance – Fair

Account for the physical constraints faced by farmers in Southern California. Discuss whether water conservation measures adopted by the local farmers can alleviate these physical constraints in the long run.

Section C – Question 7

Account for the physical constraints faced by farmers in Southern California. Discuss whether water conservation measures adopted by the local farmers can alleviate these physical constraints in the long run.

Part	Explanatory notes
1st	✓ briefly stated the physical constraints encountered by the farmers in S.C. ✓ commonly stated the constraint of low annual rainfall

Section C – Question 7

Account for the physical constraints faced by farmers in Southern California.
Discuss whether water conservation measures adopted by the local farmers can alleviate these physical constraints in the long run.

Part	Explanatory notes
1st	➢ failed to describe accurately the temporal and spatial differences in physical setting, e.g. from coast to inland ➢ wrong descriptions about S.C.: in Southern Hemisphere, close to Equator ➢ incorrect argument: low annual rainfall was the cause of low soil fertility ➢ irrelevant content: a lengthy explanation of the semi-arid climate, including the angle of the sun, pressure belt and the wind system of the area

Section C – Question 7

Account for the physical constraints faced by farmers in Southern California. Discuss whether water conservation measures adopted by the local farmers can alleviate these physical constraints in the long run.

Part	Explanatory notes
2nd	✓ pointed out that water conservation measures could save water ✓ commonly stated drip irrigation and precision farming

Section C – Question 7

Account for the physical constraints faced by farmers in Southern California. Discuss whether water conservation measures adopted by the local farmers can alleviate these physical constraints in the long run.

Part	Explanatory notes
2nd	➢ demonstrated a limited understanding of water conservation ➢ misconceptions: gravity irrigation and sprinkler irrigation could conserve water resources ➢ failed to accurately explain the specific operation of the methods and their effectiveness in conserving water resources, e.g. the applications of remote sensing technology and GIS in precision farming to save irrigation water ➢ irrelevant content: the construction of dams, reservoirs and aqueducts ➢ wrong arguments: poverty and low education level ➢ failed to analyse the effectiveness of the measures in the long run

Section C – Question 8

Popularity – 22%
Performance – Satisfactory

Account for the increasing carbon dioxide emissions in the less developed countries since 1990. Discuss the effectiveness of using alternative energy in reducing the global carbon dioxide emissions.

Section C – Question 8

Account for the increasing carbon dioxide emissions in the less developed countries since 1990. Discuss the effectiveness of using alternative energy in reducing the global carbon dioxide emissions.

Part	Explanatory notes
1st	✓ briefly stated the reasons for there being an increase in CO_2 emissions in LDCs since 1990 ✓ understood that the industrial development and the rising living standards in LDCs have led to increased burning of fossil fuels ✓ provided relevant elaboration for explanation, e.g. the rising living standard in LDCs led to the rise of private car ownership and an increase in using electronic appliances

Section C – Question 8

Account for the increasing carbon dioxide emissions in the less developed countries since 1990. Discuss the effectiveness of using alternative energy in reducing the global carbon dioxide emissions.

Part	Explanatory notes
1st	➢ failed to point out the relevancy of global sourcing or frequent global flow of people and goods ➢ irrelevant content: reduction of carbon sinks and increasing cattle ranching

Section C – Question 8

Account for the increasing carbon dioxide emissions in the less developed countries since 1990. Discuss the effectiveness of using alternative energy in reducing the global carbon dioxide emissions.

Part	Explanatory notes
2nd	✓ correctly named the examples of alternative energy ✓ briefly discussed the effectiveness and common limitations of alternative energy in reducing CO_2 emissions

Section C – Question 8

Account for the increasing carbon dioxide emissions in the less developed countries since 1990. Discuss the effectiveness of using alternative energy in reducing the global carbon dioxide emissions.

Part	Explanatory notes
2nd	➢ failed to describe accurately and in detail the generation of electricity from alternative energy, e.g. 'hydropower requires water to generate electricity' ➢ commonly failed to explain the specific geographical environment and specific constraints required for the development of different alternative energy ➢ irrelevant content: the development of electric vehicles, carbon trading

General comments and recommendations

General answering skills

1. Candidates should read the questions more carefully and pay attention to the question words.
2. Annotations should be adhered to the drawings.
3. Candidates should have a clear stance and make proper judgement when comparing the appropriateness of two measures.

General comments and recommendations

1. Candidates generally demonstrated a basic understanding of all modules.
2. In Section A, the overall performance of candidates was satisfactory.
3. In Section B, the sub-questions about basic geographical concepts were mostly well answered.
4. In Section C, most candidates performed fairly in the first part of the questions. Candidates demonstrated basic to intermediate understanding of the relevant concepts when answering the first part of the question.
5. Candidates should employ better time management and better control of time when answering each section. Their answers were too brief when answering short essay questions.

Review of Candidates' Performance

2024 HKDSE Geography Paper 2

General comments and recommendations

- Compared to previous years, candidates had improvement in reading and interpreting geographical data. Their answers were also more organised and included key geographical concepts.

- Candidates should go back to basics to spell key geographical terms correctly, they should use them properly to show their understanding of the relevant topics.

General comments and recommendations

- Candidates should interpret the wording of the question properly, not only by paying attention to directive terms.
- In answering data/skill-based questions, candidates should make best use of the relevant data provided, before integrating their own knowledge into their answer.
- Instead of reciting all they have learned, candidates should select carefully ideas and concepts that were relevant to the question in their answers.

General comments and recommendations

- Candidates should pay attention not to repeat the errors mentioned in previous examination reports.
- Candidates should read the questions carefully, and organise their answers logically rather than write irrelevant answers or recite knowledge without showing how it is applicable to the question.
- In view of the rapid changes in technology and socioeconomic environment, it is essential for candidates to update their geographical knowledge.

Section D Question 1

Dynamic Earth: the building of Hong Kong

Relevant concepts:

- Rock types in Hong Kong
- Geological features
- Landform distribution
- Impact of urbanisation
- Weathering

Section D Question 1 (a)(i)

Figure 1a shows the physical and human settings of area A. Photograph 1b shows a specimen of clastic sedimentary rock P at site X. Photograph 1c shows a specimen of clastic sedimentary rock Q at site Y. Photograph 1d shows a weathering feature at site X.

(a) Refer to Figure 1a and Photograph 1b.

(i) Name clastic sedimentary rock P.

(1 mark)



Section D Question 1 (a)(i)

- Most candidates named the rock correctly.
- A small number of candidates did not know the difference between the names of igneous and sedimentary rocks.

Section D Question 1 (a)(ii)

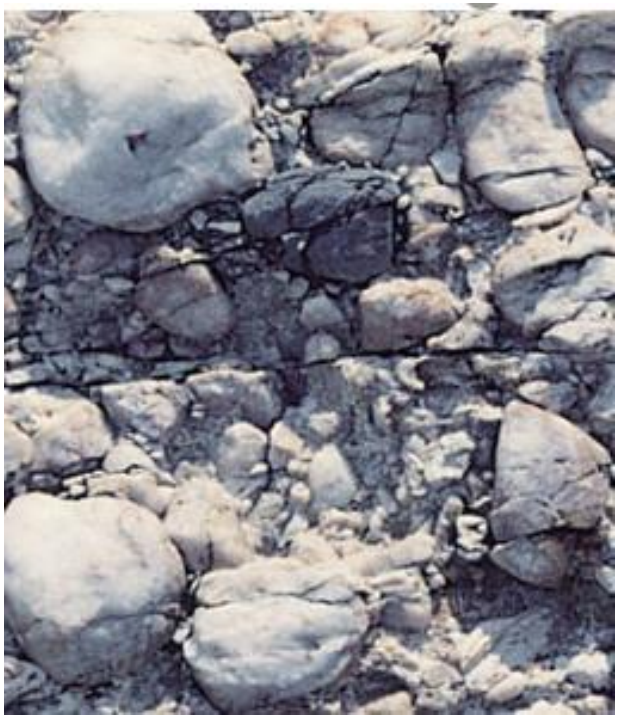
Describe and explain the characteristics of clastic sedimentary rock P

(5 marks)

- Most candidates were good at describing the characteristics of sedimentary rocks.
- Very few recognised that the rock was well-sorted and formed in a calm water body.
- Some provided a lengthy account of sedimentary rock formation instead of explaining its characteristics.

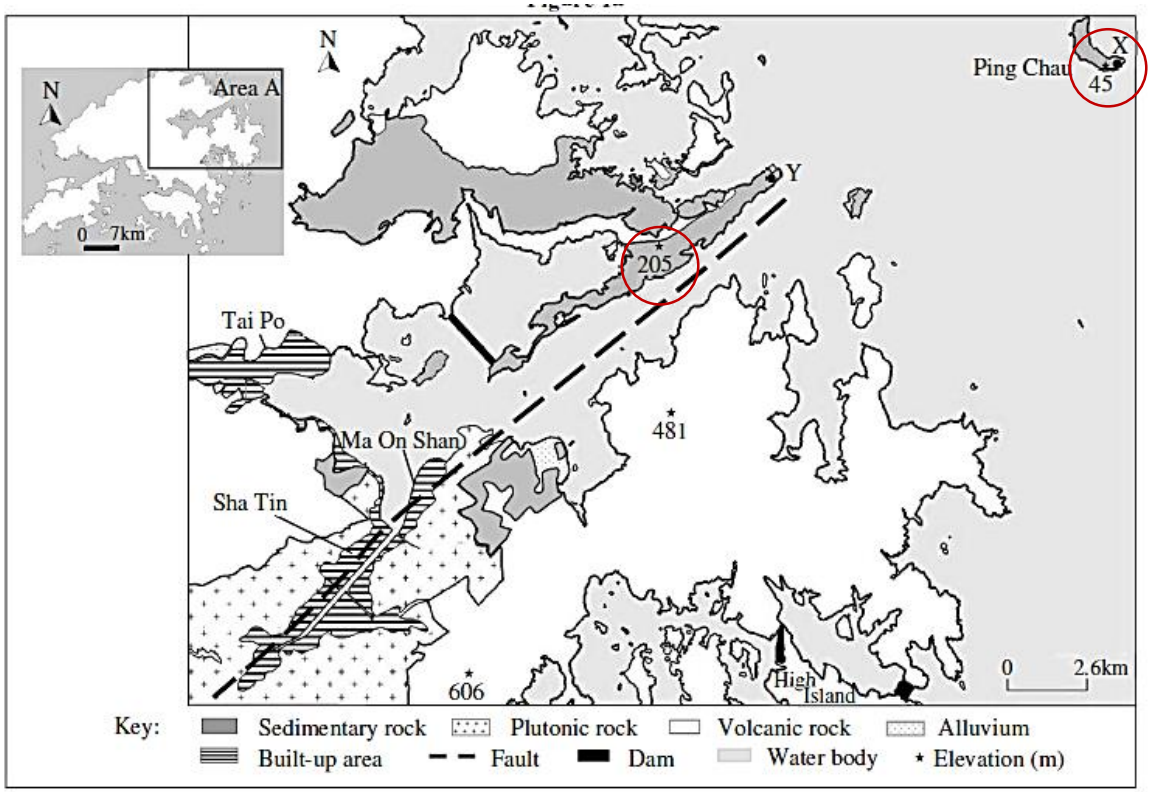
Section D Question 1 (b)

Refer to Figure 1a, Photograph 1b and Photograph 1c. Account for the impact of rock characteristics on relief. (3 marks)



- Most candidates were not able to identify rock Q as conglomerate in Photograph 1c.
- They did not understand the specific features of the rock based on the photograph.

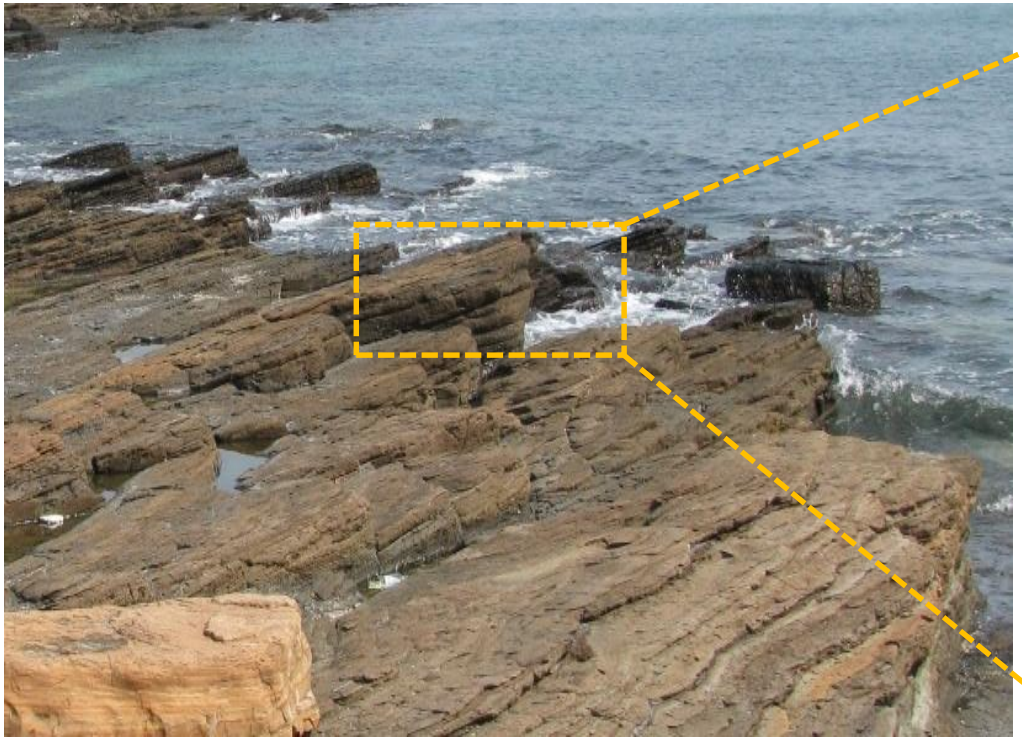
Section D Question 1 (b)

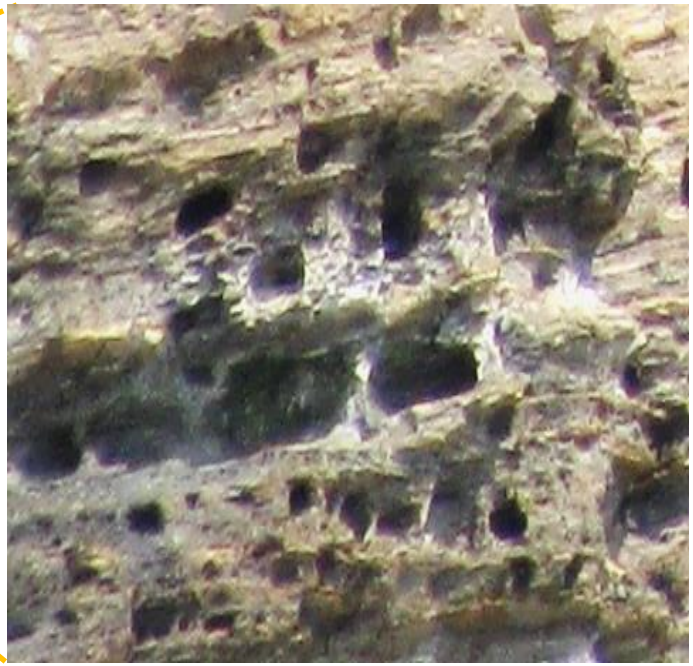


- Many did not consider the information provided to explain the impact of various characteristics of different rock types on relief.

Section D Question 1 (c)(i)

Refer to Photograph 1d. What is the physical weathering process shown in Photograph 1d? (1 mark)





Section D Question 1 (c)(i)

- Most candidates wrongly named the physical weathering process.
- Most wrongly identified it as honeycomb weathering as they failed to differentiate between the form and the process of weathering.

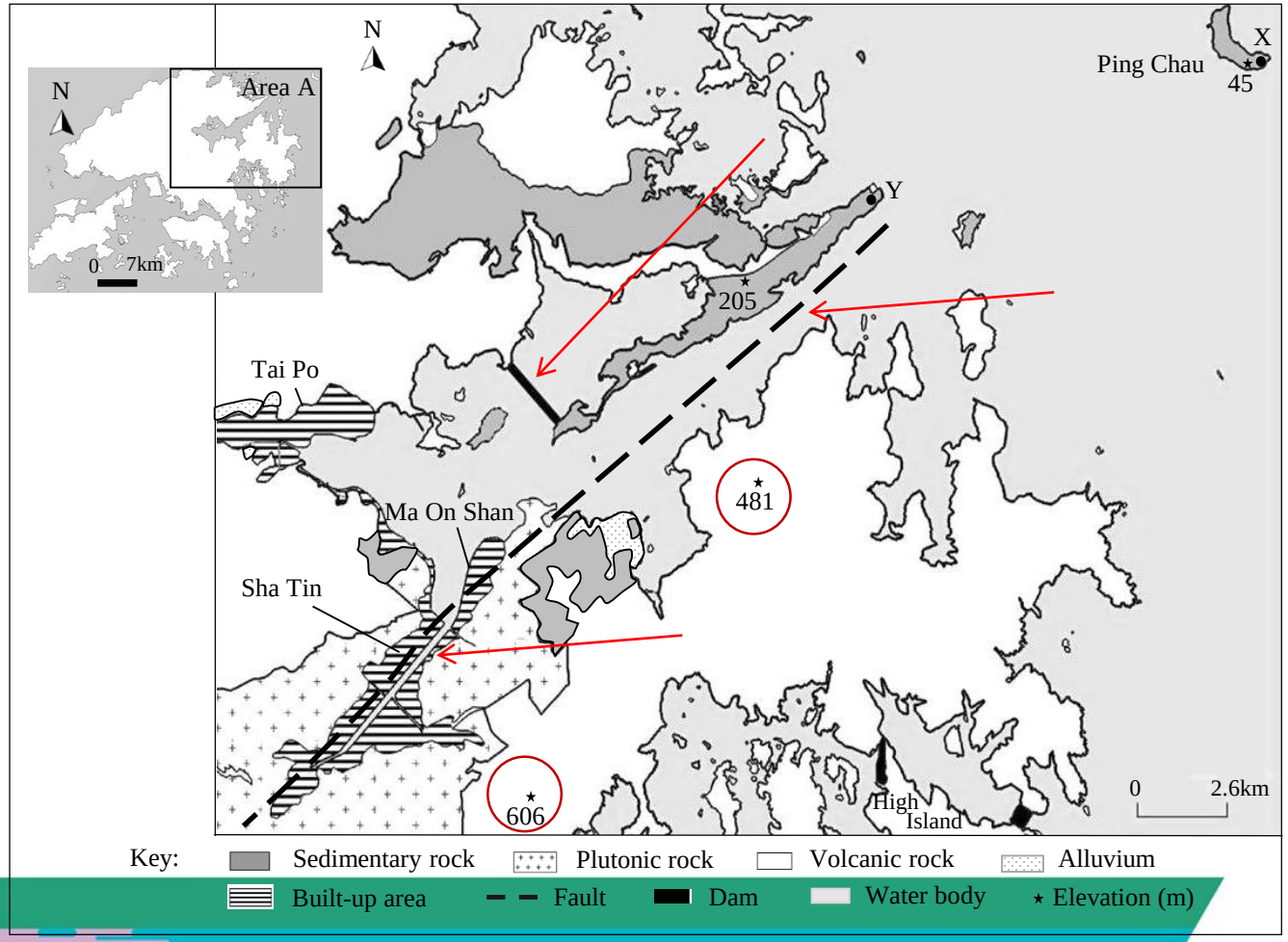
Section D Question 1 (c)(ii)

Explain the physical weathering process in (c)(i) with reference to its geographical location. (4 marks)

- Most candidates correctly identified the geographical location shown in Photograph 1d.
- Most understood that the process was caused by the influence of saltwater/seawater.
- Very few provided a comprehensive and accurate explanation of the physical weathering process.
- Many provided an imprecise description, for example 'The penetration of seawater into cracks leads to the formation of honeycombed features in the rocks.'
- A small number of candidates wrongly described the process as erosion.

Section D Question 1 (d)

Refer to Figure 1a. Discuss the importance of geological characteristics of area A in shaping the physical landscape of the area. (4 marks)



Section D Question 1 (d)

- Some were able to match the geological features with corresponding physical landscapes, but no explanation was then provided.
- Some candidates limited themselves to repeating their answers in 1(b) instead of discussing the importance of the geological characteristics shown in Figure 1a.
- Some wrongly recited all subject content to explain how different rock types affect relief in HK.
- They gave irrelevant examples such as Tai Mo Shan and hexagonal columnar jointing in relation to the characteristics of volcanic rocks.
- Few made good use of the information provided and discussed the influence of human activities on the physical landscape.

Section D Question 2

Weather and Climate

Relevant concepts:

- Energy budget (insolation)
- Atmospheric circulation (planetary wind systems)

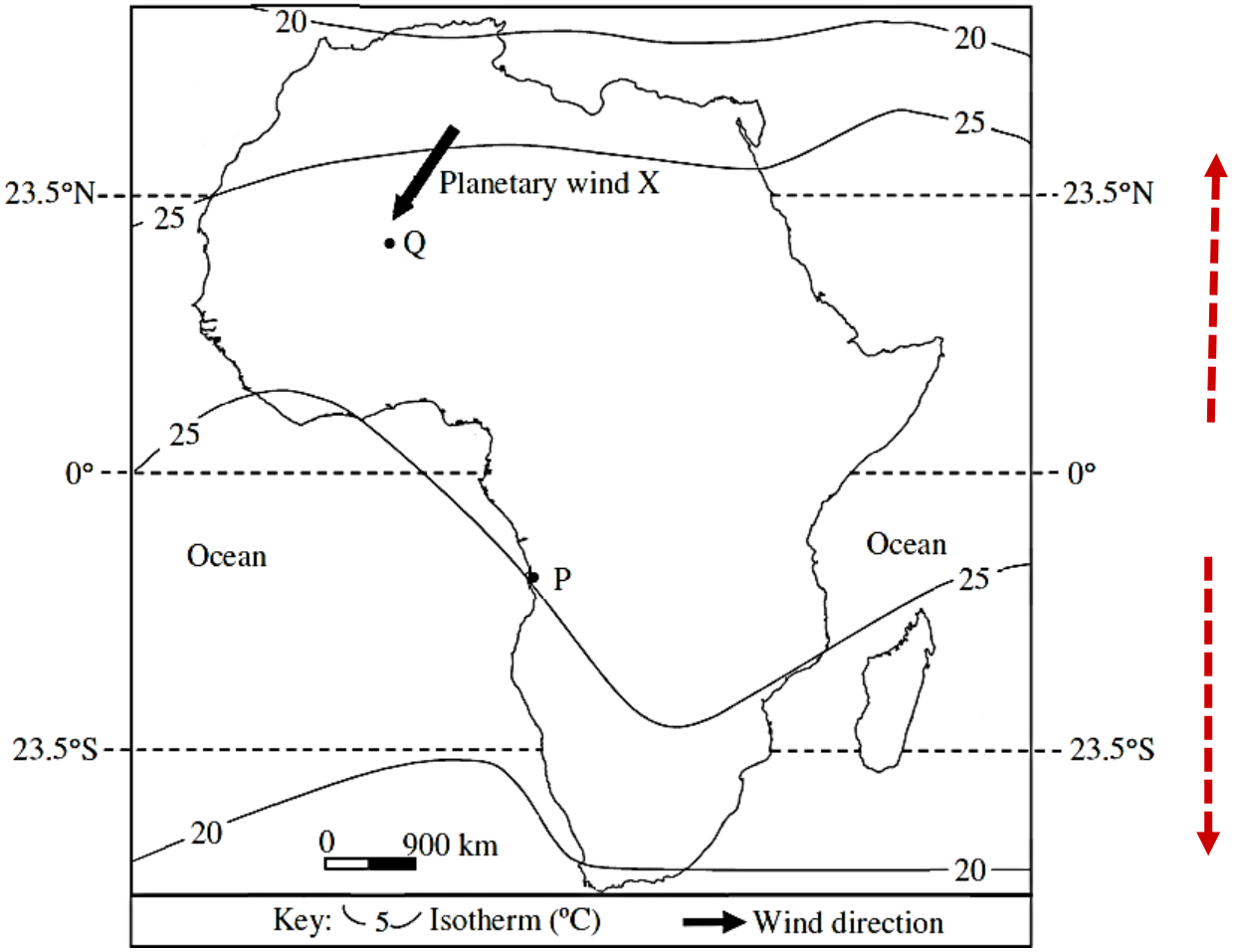
Section D Question 2 (a)

Figure 2a shows the distribution of the annual mean sea-level temperature of Africa, the locations of cities P and Q, and planetary wind X in July. Figure 2b shows the temperature graphs of cities P and Q.

(a) Refer to Figure 2a. Describe and explain the latitudinal change in the annual mean sea-level temperature of Africa. (4 marks)

- Most candidates correctly described a decrease in the annual mean sea-level temperature with an increase in latitude.
- They understood that the amount of insolation received was subject to the angle of the sun.
- A small number misinterpreted the question as asking the 'sea' temperature in the sea, or asking to compare temperature in the Northern and Southern Hemispheres etc.
- Some had the misconception that the atmosphere was thinner at the Equator, and thicker at the Poles.

Section D Question 2 (a)



Section D Question 2 (b) (i) (ii) (iii)

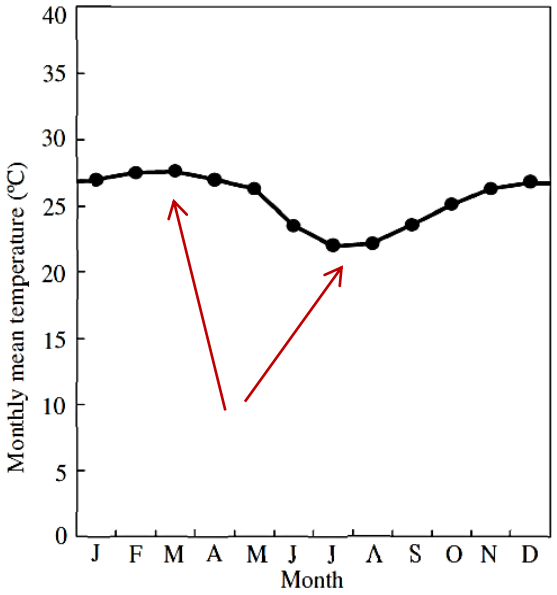
(b) Refer to Figures 2a and 2b.

(i) Match temperature graphs A and B with cities P and Q. (1 mark)

(ii) Describe the annual range of temperature of city P. (1 mark)

(iii) Explain how the geographical location affects the annual range of temperature of city P. (5 marks)

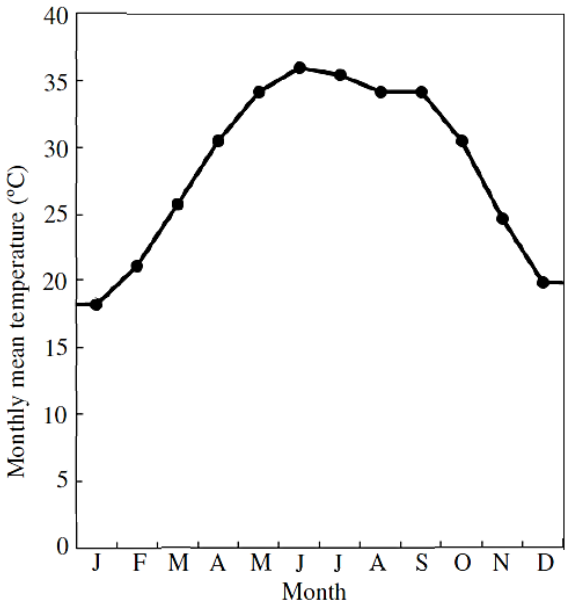
Section D Question 2 (b) (i) (ii) (iii)

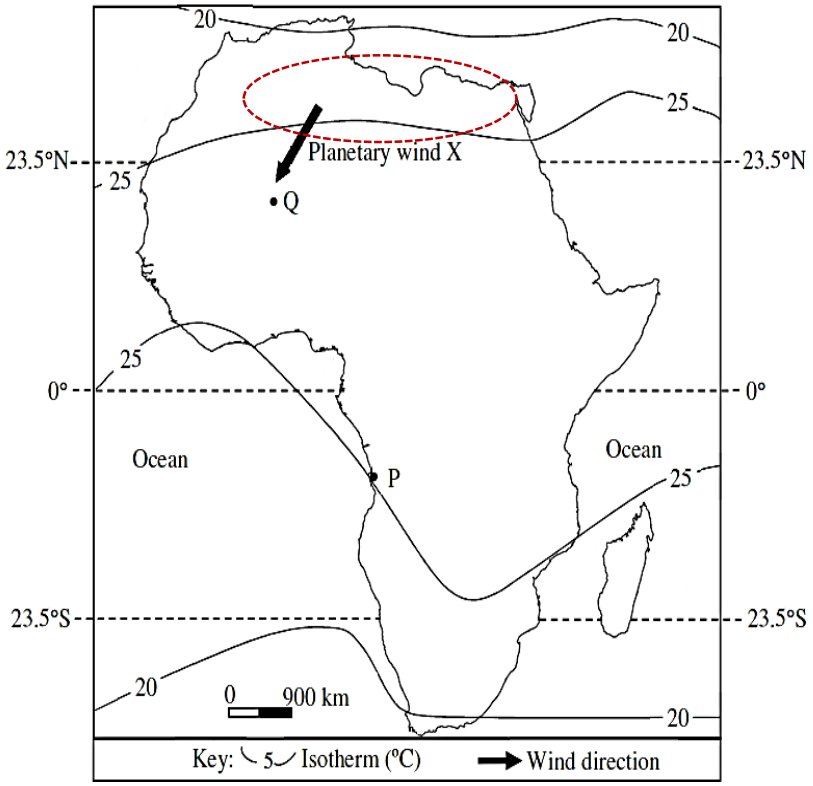


- Most candidates were able to match the two temperature graphs with corresponding cities.
- Most candidates were able to describe correctly a small annual range of temperature
- Most candidates correctly explained the small annual range of temperature of city P is due to its equatorial and coastal location
- A small number wrote the temperature value, or gave inexact terms such as ‘not large’ and ‘insignificant’
- However, some concepts provided were not applicable to the condition of city P, such as influence of onshore wind, year-round longest daylight hours at Equator.

Section D Question 2 (c) (i)

Refer to Figures 2a and 2b. Explain the formation of planetary wind X. (3 marks)





- The formation of planetary wind X was well explained
- Some gave the wrong wind direction

Section D Question 2 (c) (ii)

Discuss the relative importance of planetary wind X in affecting the temperature of city Q in July. (4 marks)

- Candidates with fair performance were able to cite the low latitude and inland location as other factors in their discussion.
- Very few candidates were able to identify the source of planetary wind X.
- They commonly did not understand that the hot and dry winds originated from subsiding air of the subtropical high pressure belt.
- Most described wind X as a cool and moist wind from the sea or higher latitudes.
- Some gave answers with wrong concepts; for example that wind X was onshore and brought moisture to reduce temperature.
- Some wrote irrelevant factors such as onshore/offshore winds, ocean currents, shifting of ITCZ etc.

Section D Question 3

Transport Development, Planning and Management

Relevant concepts

- Transport systems (linkage, network, flow)
- Modal choice and competition

Section D Question 3 (a)

Table 3a shows the information related to the three harbour crossing tunnels in 2021. Figure 3b shows the major commercial areas, the location of new towns and some transportation information in Hong Kong. Figure 3c shows the percentage of various vehicle types using the three harbour crossing tunnels during the peak hours in 2021.

Harbour crossing tunnel	Capacity utilisation (%)	Average peak-hour journey time for crossing the tunnel# (minutes)
Cross-Harbour Tunnel	136.9	33.5
Eastern Harbour Crossing	101.1	14
Western Harbour Crossing	48.5	3

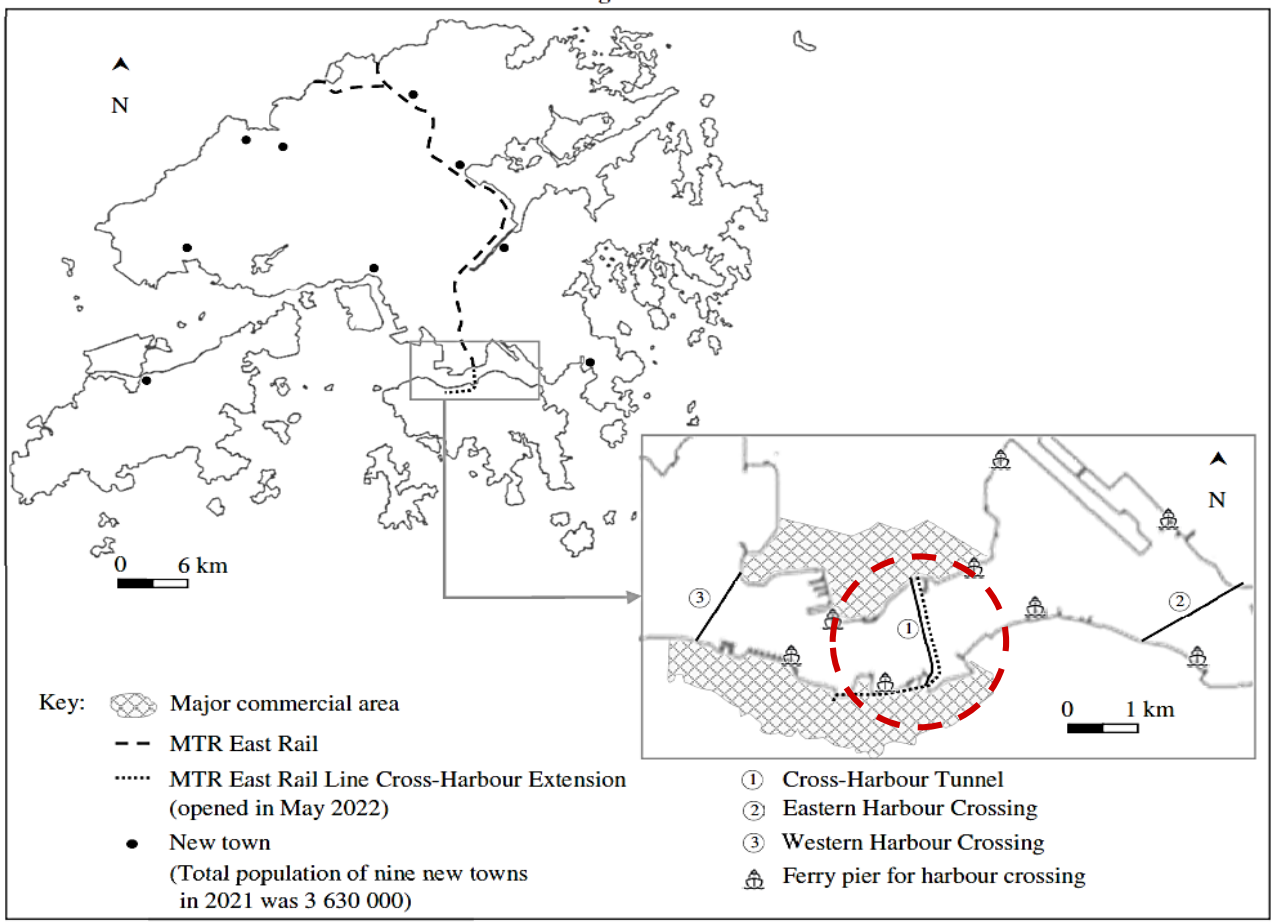
Time required to travel to the tunnel exit including wait time in queue entering tunnel

(a) Refer to Table 3a. Which tunnel has the heaviest traffic load? Give evidence to support your answer. (2 marks)

- Most candidates were able to name the Cross-Harbour Tunnel as the tunnel with the heaviest traffic load correctly, and quoted relevant data given as evidence.

Section D Question 3 (b)

Refer to Figure 3b. How is the traffic condition of the tunnel in (a) affected by its location? (4 marks)



Section D Question 3 (b)

- Almost all showed that they understood that the traffic congestion problem happened at the Cross-Harbour Tunnel.
- Many correctly mentioned the proximity of the tunnel to the major commercial areas.
- Very few were aware of the fact that it had an advantage due to its central location when compared with the other two tunnels.
- Very few explained the large number of commuters or the fact that the high demand of cross harbour passenger transport caused the problem.

Section D Question 3 (c) (i) (ii)

Refer to Table 3a and Figure 3b. Explain how the promotion of the use of

(i) the MTR East Rail Line Cross-Harbour Extension; and (4 marks)

(ii) the cross-harbour passenger ferry (4 marks)

may lower the traffic load of the tunnel in (a).

Section D Question 3 (c) (i) (ii)

- Most candidates pointed out that rail transport was more efficient and reliable than road transport
- Some candidates correctly mentioned that railway connected the new towns and the major commercial area.
- Many candidates noted that there were many ferry piers in the harbour, but did not recognise their location near the major commercial areas.

Section D Question 3 (c) (i) (ii)

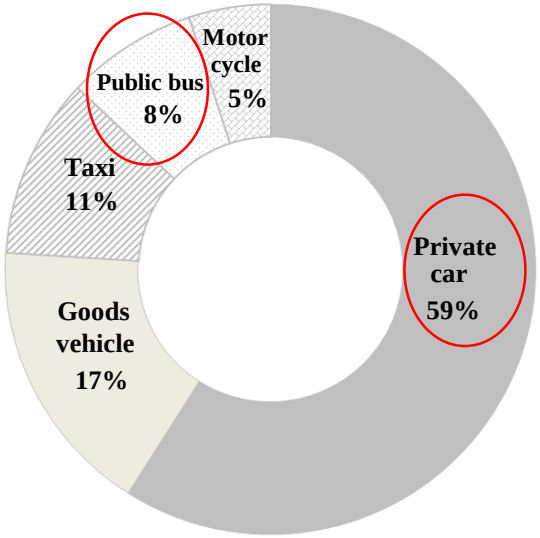
- Very few were able to state the advantage of their higher passenger load.
- Very few were able to recognise that the extended railway line brought a diversion effect on the cross-harbour ridership of other railway lines and the road transport.
- Very few noted that ferries were a substitute to road transport, or concluded that they could reduce the vehicular flow at the tunnel.

Section D Question 3 (d)

It is suggested that two traffic lanes be designated for public buses and emergency vehicles for the tunnel in (a). One of the lanes will be for southbound traffic, the other lane will be for northbound traffic. These will be operated during peak hours.

Refer to Table 3a, Figure 3b and Figure 3c.

Discuss whether the suggestion is appropriate for improving the traffic conditions of the three harbour crossing tunnels. (4 marks)



Section D Question 3 (d)

- Many candidates showed that private cars shared the largest proportion of cross-harbour vehicles, which was the root cause of the problem,
- Some concluded that the suggested measure would intensify the congestion problem.
- Some stated that the flow of public buses would be improved by the suggested measure, but they did not go on to describe how the commuters may shift from private cars to public buses.
- Very few showed that the suggested measure might bring a diversion effect on the other two tunnels, especially the West Harbour Tunnel.

Section D Question 4

Regional study of Zhujiang (Pearl) River Delta

Relevant concepts:

- Factors affecting industrial development
- Changes over time
- Environmental degradation and management

Section D Question 4

Table 4a shows the socio-economic information related to Guangzhou in 2013 and 2021. Figure 4b shows the information related to the river water quality of Guangzhou in 2013 and 2021 and a recent photograph of a river section in Guangzhou. Figure 4c shows a simplified Zhujiang drainage network.

(a) Refer to Table 4a.

(i) Describe the changes in the percentage share of gross industrial output value of low-tech and high-tech industries of Guangzhou between 2013 and 2021. (2 marks)

(ii) Explain the changes in (a)(i). (4 marks)

Section D Question 4 (a) (i) (ii)

		2013	2021
Share of gross industrial output value (%)	Textile and garment manufacturing	4.9	1.9
	Raw chemical materials and related products manufacturing	10.7	5.7
	Computer, communication and electronic equipment manufacturing	23.5	26.7
	Medicine manufacturing	1.4	2.2
Gross industrial output value (100 million RMB)		1 720	2 310
Minimum wage (RMB)		1 550	2 300
Number of graduates from tertiary education (in thousand)		241	320
Research and development expenditure in GDP (%)		1.9	3.1
Government policy		Cleaner Production Inspection (since 2013) Environmental Protection Tax (since 2018)	

Section D Question 4 (a) (i) (ii)

- Most candidates described the industrial changes correctly.
- A small number copied the figures of 2013 and 2021. They did not categorise the industries into ‘low-tech’ and ‘high-tech’. Neither did they make comment on or describe the percentage change.

Section D Question 4 (a) (i) (ii)

- Most only provided imprecise explanation of the industrial changes.
- Many candidates did not give clear explanations of ‘low-tech’ and ‘high-tech’ industries respectively. Data in Table 4a were not used appropriately.
- For example, an increase in minimum wage was commonly cited as an advantage of high-tech industries in order to have ‘more highly-paid labour’; environmental protection tax was named as a favourable factor for the ‘cleaner’ high-tech industries.

Section D Question 4 (b) (i)

Refer to Table 4a and Figure 4b. Explain how the changes in the types of industries in Guangzhou affect its river water quality. (4 marks)

- Candidates did not make good use of the data in Table 4a and Figure 4b.
- They recited some textbook knowledge of the 'advantages for the environment of a shift from low-tech high-polluting industries to high-tech low-polluting industries', which was not relevant.
- They commonly explained the advantages associated with the development of high-tech industries, but neglected the impact of closing down the more polluting industries.

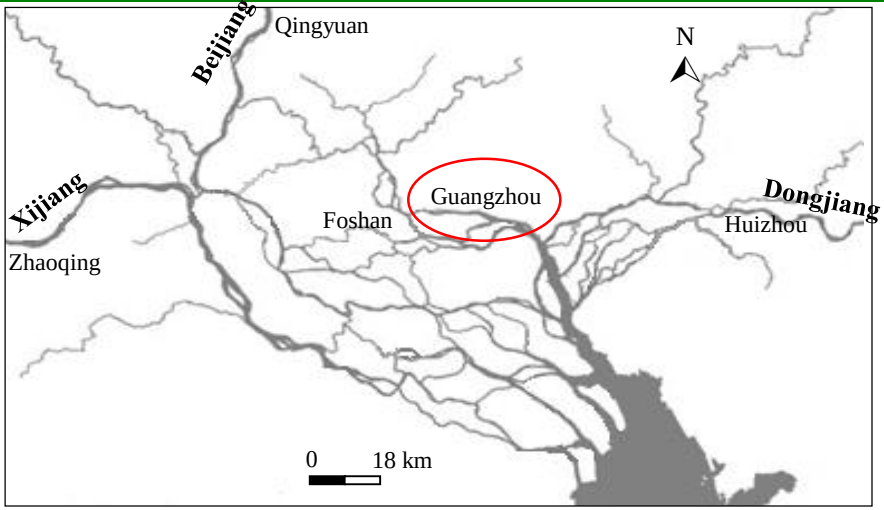
Section D Question 4 (b) (ii)

- Most candidates perceived all high-tech industries as less polluting.
- A small number of candidates gave irrelevant statements about air pollution or greenhouse gases in their answers.

(ii) Describe the socio-environmental impact brought about by the change in the river water quality of Guangzhou in (b)(i). (4 marks)

- Most candidates correctly identified the socio-environmental impact.
- However, a small number of candidates wrongly stated the economic impact, including better living standards and revenue for the tourism sector

Section D Question 4 (c)



An inter-city cooperation management agreement has been enforced in Beijiang drainage basin.

Refer to Table 4a, Figure 4b and Figure 4c. Comment on the importance of inter-city cooperation in maintaining the river water quality in Guangzhou. (4 marks)

- Most candidates stressed the importance of inter-city cooperation.
- They understood the close association between Guangzhou and the other ZRD cities regarding the river network shown in Figure 4c.
- Very few showed an understanding of how city governments could collaborate and tackle related challenges.

Section E Question 5

Dynamic Earth: The building of Hong Kong

Explain how the characteristics of granite affect weathering and landslides in Hong Kong. Discuss whether the building of check dams is an appropriate slope management measure to alleviate the impact brought about by landslides around the granitic slopes in the territory.

Relevant concepts:

- Geological hazard - landslides (causes, slope management)

Section E Question 5 (Part 1)

- Candidates showed a good understanding of the characteristics of granite, weathering and landslides,
- They did not state how weathering and landslides were associated with characteristics of granite.
- They commonly described the formation of granite instead.
- They over-stressed the occurrence of physical weathering (e.g. thermal expansion, salt weathering) and biological weathering on granite in Hong Kong.

Section E Question 5 (Part 1)

- In addition, candidates commonly recited the process of spheroidal weathering and its resultant landform features, i.e. corestones/tors.
- Such candidates neglected the presence of thick regolith which was prone to landslides.
- Most candidates showed that they understood the process and the mechanism of a landslide, but very few were able to relate the weathering processes to the occurrence of landslides.
- Some candidates tried to cite landslide examples in Hong Kong, but very few of them occurred on granitic slopes.

Section E Question 5 (Part 2)

- Most candidates correctly explained the major function of a check dam, i.e. to trap landslide debris.
- A check dam was wrongly regarded as holding up rainwater, reducing surface runoff etc.
- Some answers were unconvincing, for example that ‘the check dam may be destroyed by large landslides’, ‘the building of the dam increased stress on the slope’.

Section E Question 5 (Part 2)

- The main shortcoming of candidates was overlooking the phrase **'to alleviate the impact brought about by landslides**'.
- Candidates commonly mentioned engineering measures to prevent landslide occurrence - soil nails, an impermeable layer on slopes, improve drainage etc., which were not relevant to the discussion.
- Some candidates mentioned the factor of cost/maintenance in their discussion, but with little elaboration.
- Very few candidates mentioned the flexible barrier as an alternative, or showed that they understood that a check dam was usually used on natural slopes.

Section E Question 6

Weather and Climate

Describe and explain the formation of the global pressure belts. Discuss the relative importance of these pressure belts in affecting the distribution pattern of precipitation in the region between 30º N/S and 90 º N/S.

Relevant concepts:

- Atmospheric circulation (global pressure pattern)
- Humidity and condensation (precipitation)

Section E Question 6 (Part 1)

- Most candidates were able to name the global pressure belts correctly and provided a good account for their formation.
- Most candidates showed good understanding of how temperature affects air pressure.
- However, the explanations that they provided related to atmospheric circulation were partially wrong; for example that subpolar lows was formed by the rising of warm tropical air over cool polar air (not rising of converging warm airmasses).
- Some candidates failed to indicate the exact location of the pressure belts, giving a vague range such as 0°-30° of latitude, 60°-90° of latitude instead.
- Candidates also provided irrelevant descriptions of the planetary winds and seasonal shift of pressure belts in their answers.

Section E Question 6 (Part 2)

- Most candidates understood the importance of pressure belts on precipitation
- They correctly explained the low precipitation at the subtropical and polar highs, and relatively higher precipitation at the subpolar lows.
- They understood that the meeting of air masses at the subpolar lows caused frontal rain, and that low temperature/subsiding cold air at the polar highs was not favourable for precipitation.

Section E Question 6 (Part 2)

- In addition, some answers included common misconceptions like that sinking air is cold and therefore that it is difficult to have rain in the subtropics.
- Some candidates were able to state other factors affecting the distribution of patterns of precipitation such as relief, onshore/offshore winds, distance from sea, ocean currents etc.
- However, relevant examples of the resulting distribution patterns of precipitation in different parts of the world were absent from candidates' answers.
- Very few cited places with seasonal rainfall resulting from the seasonal shift of global wind and pressure belts.

Section E Question 7

Transport Development, Planning and Management

Describe the factors affecting the modal choice of land passenger transport. Comment on the effectiveness of High Speed Rail (Hong Kong Section) in enhancing the role of Hong Kong as a passenger transportation hub.

Relevant concepts:

Transport pattern (personal travel)

- Changes over time and space
- Hong Kong as a transport hub

Section E Question 7 (Part 1)

- Most candidates only gave brief and ambiguous descriptions of how people choose their transport modes to commute daily.
- Very few candidates demonstrated an understanding of concept of modal choice.
- They thus failed to state the merits and limitations of different modes of land transport.
- Factors such as time, price, speed and accessibility were only vaguely mentioned.
- Most candidates were not familiar with the factors such as reliability, flexibility, availability of service and inter/multi-modal connections.

Section E Question 7 (Part 2)

- Candidates' understanding of the High Speed Rail (Hong Kong Section) was superficial.
- They commonly described the merits of the High Speed Rail (compared with the East Rail) as a means to travel between Hong Kong and the Mainland.
- Candidates had little understanding of the concept of a 'passenger transportation hub', thus they rarely gave sound comments on the topic.
- Very few were able to state its connectivity with the Mainland's national high-speed rail network when examining its effectiveness.
- Only a very small number of candidates cited the connection of High Speed Rail with local transport networks such as MTR and the Hong Kong International Airport.
- Candidates' performance was poor as they failed to apply relevant transport geography concepts to this question.

Section E Question 8

Regional study of Zhujiang (Pearl) River Delta

Account for the adverse impact of urbanisation on the agriculture in the Zhujiang Delta Region since the 1990s. Discuss whether advanced sustainable farming technologies can combat the adverse impact of urbanisation on the agriculture in the region.

Relevant concepts:

- Factors affecting agricultural development
- Changes over time

Section E Question 8 (Part 1)

- Most candidates gave comprehensive answers and showed their understanding of the adverse impact of urbanisation on the agriculture in ZDR.
- However, some candidates apparently overlooked the timeline 'since the 1990s'.
- They therefore described the development in the 1980s, which was not relevant to the question.
- As regards the environmental impact, some candidates described in detail the impact of industrialisation, instead of urbanisation.
- A small number of candidates erroneously cited the 'village-in-the-city' development as a factor leading to the loss of farmland.
- Despite lengthy answers provided, very few candidates cited relevant examples to illustrate how urbanisation affected agriculture in the ZDR.

Section E Question 8 (Part 2)

- Some candidates overlooked one or more key terms such as **‘advanced’, ‘sustainable’ and ‘technology’**.
- In general, candidates did not show that they had a good understanding of the nature of technology. Irrelevant answers such as farm machinery, GM crops, irrigation, leisure farms, chemical fertilisers were given.
- Some candidates correctly named measures like greenhouse, hydroponics, and precision farming, but did not further elaborate their effectiveness in combating the adverse impact mentioned in the first part of the question.

Section E Question 8 (Part 2)

- They erroneously asserted that capital and technology were the limitations of developing advanced sustainable farming technology in the ZDR. They did not understand the present socio-economic development of the region.
- They commonly stated the merits and the limitations of related technologies
- Most candidates failed to show their judgement on whether the technologies could combat the adverse impact of urbanisation as a whole.

Q&A

Reminders for Candidates in 2025 Geography Examination

1. ***DO NOT*** *allow to use self-made transparent plastic sheets with gridlines in the examination*
2. ***DO NOT*** *use colour pencils, colour marker pens or highlighters*
3. ***CLEAR HANDWRITING*** *and* ***PAGE LAYOUT*** *are essential for accurate marking*
4. ***WRITE CLEARLY*** *by crossing out/ deleting all unwanted words*
5. *Mark carefully and accurately the* ***QUESTION NUMBER*** *on* ***EACH PAGE*** *of the Answer Book, especially in* ***Sections C & D of Paper 1***
6. *Start* ***EACH*** *question (not part of a question) on a* ***NEW*** *page*
7. *Study carefully the 2025 Handbook for Candidates*

Thank You for Your Participation

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